

ENGLISH FOR CUSTOMER CONVERSATIONS

Sales and Business Development English

Understand the need. Earn the next step.



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Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases

160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps

Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For sales representatives, account executives, business development teams, sales engineers, channel managers, and commercial leaders.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight commercial conversations: discover a real need, connect capability to an outcome, compare competing offers, handle a discount request, map buying roles, route contract changes, define a partnership proposal, and correct an unsupported forecast.

01 Discovery and Qualification

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Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides | Clarify the workflow, problem, and buying steps without turning a demonstration request into a purchase commitment.

02 Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit

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04 Pricing, Discounting, and Approval

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A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes | Route the exact proposed contract change for review without accepting it or promising a legal outcome.

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Persuasive language. Reliable commitments.

Good sales English makes a customer problem and the next decision clear. These conversations practice relevant questions, credible value claims, fair comparisons, bounded negotiation, and accurate internal reporting. A positive response is useful information, but it is not the same as budget, approval, or a signed order.

Make discovery useful to the customer

Explain why a question matters and connect the answer to a relevant demonstration or next step. Qualification should clarify mutual fit, not feel like an interrogation or a script that ignores the reply.

"May I understand the approval workflow so the demonstration focuses on the part that slows your team down?"

Separate capability from achieved value

A feature may support an outcome, but the customer result depends on workflow, data, adoption, and other conditions. State what is demonstrated, what is estimated, and what still needs testing.

"The tool can consolidate the inputs; the time saving in your reporting cycle still needs validation."

Negotiate within actual authority

A request can be discussed without being accepted. Confirm the exact scope, terms, and approval route before promising a discount, contract amendment, or exclusive right.

"I can submit the fifteen-percent request, but I cannot approve that reduction myself."

Record customer evidence, not sales hopes

Keep the contact, budget holder, procurement steps, and signature status distinct. A target date entered internally should not become a customer-confirmed commitment in the forecast.

"The proposed close date is our estimate; procurement has not started and the customer has not confirmed it."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All customers, products, people, quotes, contracts, prices, policies, and timelines are fictional. This book teaches professional English, not legal, financial, procurement, or product advice. Follow the actual evidence, approved claims, commercial authority, and contract-review process. FTC references concern United States advertising guidance; they are not a complete statement of applicable law. No cited organization endorses this book.

Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides

A Read the situation

Clarify the workflow, problem, and buying steps without turning a demonstration request into a purchase commitment.

Prospect Nina requests a demonstration of an approval-workflow product. Her four branch teams handle about 600 purchase requests per month through spreadsheets and email. She says managers spend time chasing status, but waiting time and the cost of the problem have not been measured. Nina coordinates operations and has not identified the budget holder, approved budget, or purchasing process. Sales representative Caleb must agree a focused demonstration objective and useful discovery steps. Product fit, savings, purchase authority, and a close date are not yet established.

PEOPLE / Nina: Prospect operations coordinator | Caleb: Sales representative

ASK WITH A REASON, THEN LISTEN

A prospect may want to see the product before answering a long list of commercial questions. Explain which few details will make the demonstration relevant and offer a focused agenda. Avoid making unknown budget information sound like a personal failure or treating curiosity as a commitment to buy.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What current workflow is described?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A A fully measured automated process | B A signed order for the new product |
| C A single branch handling six requests annually | D About 600 monthly purchase requests across four branches using spreadsheets and email |

2. What is known about the problem?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Every request waits exactly ten days. | B The product has already eliminated the delay. |
| C The customer has approved a savings figure. | D Managers chase status, but waiting time and cost have not been measured. |

3. What does the demonstration request establish?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A Confirmed budget and signing authority | B A guaranteed close date |
| C Completion of procurement | D Interest in seeing the product, not purchase approval |

Answers and explanations: [page 76](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

discovery call

A conversation to understand a prospect's situation and needs.

IN USE conduct a discovery call

qualification

Assessment of whether a sales opportunity has relevant fit and buying conditions.

IN USE complete opportunity qualification

prospect

A potential customer being considered or engaged.

IN USE understand the prospect

lead

A potential customer contact or indication of interest under the team's definitions.

IN USE follow up a lead

use case

A specific situation in which a capability would be used.

IN USE define the use case

current-state workflow

The sequence of work as it operates now.

IN USE map the current-state workflow

pain point

A practical problem or difficulty relevant to the customer.

IN USE clarify the pain point

business impact

The effect of a problem or change on the organization.

IN USE quantify business impact

discovery gap

Information still missing from understanding the opportunity.

IN USE identify a discovery gap

ICP

Ideal customer profile; characteristics used to describe a suitable target organization.

IN USE define the ICP

BANT

Budget, authority, need, and timing; a commonly used qualification checklist.

IN USE use BANT questions

budget holder

The person or function controlling the relevant funding.

IN USE identify the budget holder

Precision check

About 600 requests per month describes volume, not delay or savings. Managers chasing status identifies a problem worth examining, but neither the waiting-time baseline nor the cost is supplied. Do not turn those unknowns into a quantified benefit or a guaranteed product result.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

buying process

The customer's steps for evaluating and authorizing a purchase.

IN USE clarify the buying process

decision-maker

A person with authority over a relevant purchase decision.

IN USE identify the decision-maker

end user

A person who will use the product or service.

IN USE involve end users

technical evaluator

A person assessing relevant technical suitability.

IN USE engage the technical evaluator

demonstration

A showing of specified product capabilities.

IN USE tailor the demonstration

demo objective

The question or capability the demonstration should address.

IN USE agree the demo objective

discovery agenda

The planned topics for the initial needs conversation.

IN USE agree a discovery agenda

baseline measure

A defined current value used to assess a proposed change.

IN USE establish a baseline measure

compelling event

A customer-relevant event creating a genuine reason for timing.

IN USE verify the compelling event

next step

A specific agreed action moving the conversation forward.

IN USE agree the next step

mutual action plan

A shared sequence of customer and seller actions with owners and dates.

IN USE develop a mutual action plan

solution fit

How well a proposed offering meets the relevant need and constraints.

IN USE validate solution fit

Precision check

Unknown budget is different from confirmed absence of budget. An enthusiastic operations contact is different from a budget holder or authorized signer. Ask how the relevant decisions are made, and record what remains unknown without inventing either approval or rejection.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

RESPECT THE REQUEST

"We can show the product; first, may I clarify what would make the demonstration useful?"

REFLECT THE CURRENT PROCESS

"Four branches handle about six hundred requests a month through spreadsheets and email."

AVOID A LEADING CONCLUSION

"Is the delay in approval, information gathering, or another step?"

SEPARATE REPORT AND ESTIMATE

"The status-chasing problem is reported; its cost is not yet quantified."

ASK ABOUT THE WORKFLOW

"How does a purchase request move through approval today?"

CLARIFY THE PROBLEM

"Where do managers lose visibility or need to chase an update?"

ASK ABOUT MEASUREMENT

"Do you have a measured waiting-time baseline?"

DEFINE THE DEMONSTRATION

"Let us focus on routing requests and seeing their current status."

May I clarify

Requests cooperation and explains why discovery precedes the demonstration.

About

Preserves the approximate nature of the monthly volume.

Where

Seeks the actual problem location without supplying the answer.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP FIT PROVISIONAL

"We still need to test whether the workflow fits your requirements."

ASK ABOUT AUTHORITY RESPECTFULLY

"Who controls the relevant budget and approves a purchase?"

UNDERSTAND TIMING

"Is there a customer deadline driving the evaluation?"

AGREE A USEFUL FOLLOW-UP

"After the demonstration, we can review the fit and remaining questions together."

CLARIFY THE ROLE

"Which parts of the evaluation do you coordinate?"

AVOID ASSUMING NO BUDGET

"We have not confirmed the budget position yet."

AVOID A CLOSE-DATE PROMISE

"A demonstration does not establish a purchase date."

CLOSE DISCOVERY

"I will summarize the objective, participants, known facts, and open questions."

Not yet quantified

Keeps an observed problem distinct from an invented financial result.

Which parts

Clarifies the contact role without challenging personal status.

Open questions

Records uncertainty as work to resolve, not as an assumed refusal.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which demonstration objective fits the stated need?

- A** Ask Nina to sign before explaining the product.
- B** Show request routing and status visibility in a relevant workflow.
- C** Prove an unmeasured 80% saving.
- D** Display every feature without reference to the process.

2. Which statement about budget is accurate?

- A** No budget exists because Nina did not name it.
- B** The request for a demonstration approves the budget.
- C** The seller can choose the customer's budget holder.
- D** The budget position has not yet been confirmed.

3. Which question clarifies the buying process?

- A** Which arbitrary date should we record as confirmed?
- B** May we skip everyone else because you requested the demo?
- C** Who evaluates the fit, controls funding, and authorizes the purchase?
- D** Can we assume your enthusiasm replaces procurement?

4. Which benefit statement is supportable now?

- A** Every spreadsheet workflow is automatically unsuitable.
- B** We can examine whether status visibility addresses the problem; savings still need measurement.
- C** The product will save exactly half the team's time.
- D** Six hundred requests means six hundred hours saved.

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

Make the demonstration relevant before opening the slides

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

solution fit / pain point / buying process / use case / demo objective / current-state workflow / baseline measure / discovery gap / next step / compelling event

- 01 **Nina:** Could we see a demonstration of the approval product? We use spreadsheets and email, and managers keep asking where their requests have gone.
- 02 **Caleb:** Certainly. May I clarify the ¹ _____ first so we show the part that matters to your team? A little context will help us focus the session.
- 03 **Nina:** Four branches handle about six hundred purchase requests a month. People send spreadsheets around and then chase updates by email.
- 04 **Caleb:** That gives us the ² _____. Where does visibility break down: when a request is submitted, while it is awaiting approval, or when someone needs more information?
- 05 **Nina:** I cannot say which step accounts for most of the delay. I know managers spend time asking for status, but we have not measured the waiting time.
- 06 **Caleb:** Then the ³ _____ is clear enough to explore, while the size and location of the delay remain open. We should not attach a savings figure before understanding those details.
- 07 **Nina:** We could ask the branch leads for examples of the handoffs. I do not want to send sensitive purchasing records just to arrange a demonstration.
- 08 **Caleb:** Agreed. We can start with an appropriate process description and a ⁴ _____ if one is available. Use the approved information-sharing arrangements, and do not send personal or confidential records that we do not need.
- 09 **Nina:** For the demonstration, I mainly want to see how a manager finds the status and knows whose action is next.
- 10 **Caleb:** That is a focused ⁵ _____. We can show request routing and status visibility, then ask whether the example reflects your actual requirements instead of walking through every available feature.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Nina:** I coordinate the operational evaluation. I have not yet involved the people who would assess the system or approve the purchase.
- 12 **Caleb:** Let us clarify the ⁶ _____ without assuming your role covers every decision. Who would evaluate technical fit, control funding, and authorize a purchase if the product proves relevant?
- 13 **Nina:** I need to confirm that internally. I do not have an approved budget figure to give you today.
- 14 **Caleb:** That remains a ⁷ _____, not proof that there is no budget. We can record the position accurately and agree how to identify the relevant people rather than fill in assumptions.
- 15 **Nina:** There is no confirmed purchase date either. I am looking at possible improvements, not promising that we will buy this month.
- 16 **Caleb:** Understood. We should not invent a ⁸ _____ or treat the demonstration as a closing commitment. We can ask about genuine operational deadlines when you have that information.
- 17 **Nina:** After the demonstration, I would like the branch leads to help identify what fits and what would need further examination.
- 18 **Caleb:** That is how we can evaluate ⁹ _____. We should capture both useful capabilities and unresolved requirements, including anything that the demonstration does not establish about your environment.
- 19 **Nina:** Please send a short agenda with the workflow focus and the questions we should bring to that follow-up.
- 20 **Caleb:** I will summarize the agreed ¹⁰ _____, participants, known facts, and open questions. That will make the demonstration useful without turning your interest into a commitment you have not made.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. demo objective | 2. current-state workflow | 3. pain point | 4. baseline measure | 5. use case | 6. buying process | 7. discovery gap | 8. compelling event | 9. solution fit | 10. next step

Qualify another demonstration request

F Say it

An operations contact asks to see a scheduling product. Three sites currently coordinate by email. Missed updates are reported, but their frequency, budget, approver, and purchase date are unconfirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

three / unconfirmed / missed updates / email

Seller: "The existing coordination tool is ¹ _____."

Contact: "The reported problem is ² _____."

Seller: "The relevant number of sites is ³ _____."

Contact: "The purchase date is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. email | 2. missed updates | 3. three | 4. unconfirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change

A Read the situation

Connect a capability to a testable benefit, with a baseline and a distinction between capacity and cash savings.

Evan spends 24 staff hours preparing each monthly report: 14 consolidating inputs, 8 reviewing them, and 2 formatting the output. Sales representative Sera demonstrates automated consolidation using sample data. Evan proposes testing whether consolidation could fall from 14 to 6 hours while review and formatting remain unchanged. That would reduce total preparation to 16 hours, freeing 8 hours per cycle. No customer-data test has occurred, compatibility is unverified, and no staffing cost reduction is planned. Sera must describe a value hypothesis, not guaranteed savings or a proven return on investment.

PEOPLE / Evan: Prospect reporting lead | Sera: Sales representative

THE CUSTOMER OUTCOME COMES BEFORE THE FEATURE TOUR

A technically impressive feature may not answer the concern of the person buying it. Ask which work changes, what remains, and how the result will be checked. A credible explanation of limits can be more persuasive than a long list of capabilities detached from the customer workflow.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How is the current 24-hour cycle divided?

- | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|
| A 14 hours consolidation, 8 review, and 2 formatting | B 24 hours consolidation only |
| C 6 hours review and 18 formatting | D 8 hours total preparation |

2. What total follows from the proposed test assumption?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A Zero preparation time | B A proven total of 14 hours |
| C 16 hours, if consolidation falls to 6 and the other tasks stay unchanged | D 6 hours for the entire report |

3. What has actually been demonstrated?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A A guaranteed eight-hour saving | B A planned reduction in staffing cost |
| C Consolidation with sample data, not verified customer results | D A completed customer-data test |

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

value proposition

A clear explanation of the relevant benefit an offering is proposed to provide.

IN USE tailor the value proposition

feature

A specific capability or characteristic of a product.

IN USE demonstrate a feature

feature-to-value link

The explanation connecting a capability to a customer outcome.

IN USE explain the feature-to-value link

value hypothesis

A proposed customer benefit to be tested against evidence.

IN USE validate the value hypothesis

business outcome

A result meaningful to the customer's operation or goals.

IN USE define the business outcome

quantified benefit

A proposed or observed improvement expressed in a defined measure.

IN USE substantiate a quantified benefit

business case

An assessment of expected value, costs, conditions, and risks for a decision.

IN USE build the business case

proof of value

A bounded evaluation of whether a solution produces a relevant customer benefit.

IN USE agree a proof of value

time-to-value

The period before a defined benefit is achieved.

IN USE estimate time-to-value

value realization

Actual achievement of the intended benefit.

IN USE track value realization

workflow fit

Compatibility between the solution and the customer's actual work.

IN USE test workflow fit

manual consolidation

Combining information through human effort rather than the proposed automation.

IN USE reduce manual consolidation

Precision check

Under the proposed assumption, consolidation falls by 8 hours, and total preparation falls from 24 to 16. The total time reduction would be 8 divided by 24, approximately 33.3%. The demonstration has not established that this reduction will occur in the customer workflow.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

data readiness

Whether data meets the conditions needed for the proposed use.

IN USE assess data readiness

compatibility

Ability of components or data to work together as required.

IN USE verify compatibility

configuration

Settings or arrangements used to adapt a product to the required use.

IN USE confirm the configuration

integration

Connection between systems or processes to support the intended workflow.

IN USE scope the integration

exception handling

Work to address items that do not follow the normal path.

IN USE assess exception handling

representative dataset

Data selected to reflect the relevant real-world conditions for a test.

IN USE use a representative dataset

acceptance criterion

A defined condition for judging the agreed test or output.

IN USE set acceptance criteria

benefit owner

The person responsible for confirming and tracking a particular benefit.

IN USE identify the benefit owner

baseline

The defined current position used for comparison.

IN USE confirm the baseline

labor capacity

Staff time or capability available for work.

IN USE release labor capacity

cash saving

A reduction in actual cash expenditure under a specified comparison.

IN USE distinguish cash savings

assumption

A condition taken as true for a calculation until verified.

IN USE disclose the assumptions

Precision check

Freed staff time is potential capacity, not automatically lower payroll or cash expenditure. No staffing cost reduction is planned here. A return-on-investment calculation would also need relevant costs, timing, and a justified benefit measure that the brief does not supply.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

START WITH THE WORKFLOW

"Which part of preparing the report consumes the most time?"

LINK THE CAPABILITY

"Automated consolidation addresses the fourteen-hour input-combining step."

STATE THE HYPOTHESIS

"We would test whether consolidation can fall to six hours."

NAME THE POTENTIAL CAPACITY

"That would free eight staff hours per monthly cycle."

STATE THE BASELINE

"The current cycle takes twenty-four staff hours."

KEEP OTHER WORK VISIBLE

"Review and formatting do not disappear in this proposal."

CALCULATE CONDITIONALLY

"If the other tasks stay unchanged, total preparation would be sixteen hours."

AVOID A GUARANTEED CLAIM

"The customer-data test has not yet established that saving."

Addresses

Links a feature to a particular work step without claiming every task disappears.

Would test

Marks the benefit as a hypothesis.

If

Makes the calculation conditional on the stated assumptions.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE DEMONSTRATION AND PROOF

"Sample-data performance does not confirm compatibility with your inputs."

CHECK EXCEPTIONS

"Include the unusual inputs that currently require manual attention."

DISTINGUISH VALUE TYPES

"Released capacity is not automatically a cash saving."

STATE THE IMPLEMENTATION DEPENDENCY

"Configuration and integration requirements still need assessment."

DEFINE A USEFUL TEST

"Use an approved representative dataset and agreed success criteria."

ASSIGN BENEFIT OWNERSHIP

"Who will verify the before-and-after time measurement?"

AVOID INVENTED RETURN

"We cannot state a return on investment without the relevant costs and benefit assumptions."

CLOSE THE VALUE DISCUSSION

"Let us agree what to test, how to measure it, and what the result would establish."

Per monthly cycle

Keeps the time-saving unit explicit.

Not automatically

Separates released time from a reduction in expenditure.

What the result would establish

Defines the claim that a bounded test could legitimately support.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which value claim is accurate before the customer-data test?

- A** Eight staff hours guarantees eight hours less payroll cost.
- B** The demonstration proves every customer format is compatible.
- C** The proposed change could free eight hours per cycle if the stated assumptions hold.
- D** The product has already cut all reporting time by two thirds.

2. Why is the proposed total sixteen rather than six hours?

- A** Consolidation is counted twice.
- B** The baseline was six hours.
- C** The customer has removed all review steps.
- D** Review and formatting still require ten hours combined.

3. What should a relevant proof of value include?

- A** No baseline because the feature is impressive
- B** Approved representative inputs, exceptions, measures, and agreed criteria
- C** Only the easiest sample records
- D** A guaranteed success conclusion before testing

4. Which distinction matters for the business case?

- A** Freed staff capacity does not necessarily reduce cash spending.
- B** Every saved minute immediately reduces the invoice.
- C** Staff time has no possible value.
- D** Product cost is irrelevant to any return calculation.

Answers and explanations: page 78.

Connect the feature to the reporting work it might change

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

integration / benefit owner / representative dataset / baseline / value proposition / assumption / labor capacity / proof of value / value hypothesis / workflow fit

- 01 **Evan:** Your slide lists automated imports, reusable templates, and dashboards. What I need is less time preparing our monthly report, not another feature list.
- 02 **Sera:** Let us connect the ¹ _____ to that work. Which steps make up the current preparation time, and which one causes the largest amount of manual effort?
- 03 **Evan:** We spend twenty-four staff hours per cycle: fourteen consolidating inputs, eight reviewing them, and two formatting the output.
- 04 **Sera:** That is a useful ² _____. Automated consolidation relates to the fourteen-hour step. It does not mean the eight hours of review or two hours of formatting would disappear.
- 05 **Evan:** If consolidation could fall to six hours, the change would be useful. We could use the freed time for more analysis.
- 06 **Sera:** That gives us a ³ _____ to test. With review and formatting unchanged, the total would fall to sixteen hours, freeing eight hours per cycle. We have not yet demonstrated that result with your inputs.
- 07 **Evan:** The example you showed worked quickly, but our files vary by branch and sometimes contain exceptions that require manual correction.
- 08 **Sera:** Then ⁴ _____ remains to be checked. Sample-data performance does not establish compatibility with every branch format or remove the exception handling your team currently performs.
- 09 **Evan:** We would need an evaluation that includes those awkward inputs, not only the clean examples that are easy to automate.
- 10 **Sera:** Use an approved ⁵ _____ with appropriate information-handling arrangements. Define which formats and exceptions it covers, so we know what the result can and cannot establish.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Evan:** I can help identify the types of input and the current work steps. We should agree how to measure the time rather than rely on impressions.
- 12 **Sera:** Exactly. A bounded ⁶ _____ should specify the task boundary, measures, success criteria, and test responsibilities. Compare equivalent work, including any preparation or corrections that the new process still requires.
- 13 **Evan:** If the test frees eight hours, I will not be reducing anyone's contracted hours. The team would spend that time on analysis.
- 14 **Sera:** Then describe released ⁷ _____, not an automatic cash saving. The benefit may still be valuable, but the business case should name what actually changes instead of implying a payroll reduction.
- 15 **Evan:** Could we call it a third less report-preparation time if the full cycle goes from twenty-four hours to sixteen?
- 16 **Sera:** Approximately, under that ⁸ _____. Eight divided by twenty-four is about thirty-three point three percent. Keep the condition and the full-cycle denominator visible rather than presenting the percentage as an established result.
- 17 **Evan:** We also need to understand what configuration or connections would be required before our team could use this in a real monthly cycle.
- 18 **Sera:** Those ⁹ _____ requirements still need assessment, along with configuration and data readiness. I cannot give a reliable time-to-value or return calculation without the relevant implementation conditions and costs.
- 19 **Evan:** I will be responsible for verifying whether the measured reporting work actually changes. We can review the outcome with the team after the evaluation.
- 20 **Sera:** Good; naming the ¹⁰ _____ makes the next step clear. Let us agree the test scope, representative inputs, measures, and criteria, then use the result to support a proportionate claim about the value.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. value proposition | 2. baseline | 3. value hypothesis | 4. workflow fit | 5. representative dataset | 6. proof of value | 7. labor capacity | 8. assumption | 9. integration | 10. benefit owner

Explain another conditional time benefit

F Say it

A task takes 18 hours: 10 combining inputs, 6 reviewing, and 2 formatting. A proposed test targets 4 hours for combining, with the other work unchanged. No test result or staffing cost reduction exists.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

18 hours / 4 hours / 6 hours / 12 hours

Seller: "The current total is ¹ _____."

Buyer: "The proposed combining time is ² _____."

Seller: "The conditional new total would be ³ _____."

Buyer: "The potential time released per cycle is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. 18 hours | 2. 4 hours | 3. 12 hours | 4. 6 hours

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The lower headline price covers a different package

A Read the situation

Acknowledge a price concern and compare scope, support, and implementation without inventing competitor claims.

Daria compares an annual \$42,000 offer from Luis with a competitor quote of \$32,000. The \$42,000 offer includes ten implementation-support hours and an initial response within four support hours. Its support window is Monday to Friday, 09:00-17:00 Eastern time, excluding listed holidays. The competitor excludes implementation support, whose price is unknown, and states next-business-day initial response under its own calendar. Neither quote promises resolution within the response time. Daria sometimes needs overnight help. Luis must compare scope honestly and check coverage rather than claim his package provides round-the-clock support.

PEOPLE / Daria: Prospective buyer | Luis: Account executive

AN OBJECTION IS INFORMATION, NOT AN INSULT

A lower competitor price can reveal a real budget issue, an incomplete comparison, or a different priority. Acknowledge the difference and ask what coverage matters. Avoid treating the buyer as uninformed or asserting that the competitor must be poor quality because its headline price is lower.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the headline annual price difference?

- A No difference
- C \$32,000

- B \$10,000
- D \$42,000

2. What is unknown in the competitor offer?

- A Whether initial response means guaranteed resolution
- C The stated \$32,000 headline price

- B The price of implementation support
- D Whether Luis's offer includes ten support hours

3. Does Luis's quote provide round-the-clock support?

- A It guarantees overnight resolution.
- C Yes; four support hours always means four elapsed hours.

- B No; it specifies a weekday daytime window with holiday exclusions.
- D Yes; every annual contract includes overnight service.

Answers and explanations: page 80.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

objection

A concern or reason a buyer raises against a proposal.

IN USE clarify the objection

competitive quote

An offer from another supplier being considered.

IN USE review the competitive quote

headline price

The prominent quoted amount before examining scope and conditions.

IN USE compare headline prices

like-for-like comparison

A comparison using equivalent scope and relevant terms.

IN USE make a like-for-like comparison

TCO

Total cost of ownership over a defined period and scope.

IN USE assess TCO

scope alignment

Making the included work comparable across offers.

IN USE establish scope alignment

implementation support

Assistance with setting up and introducing the offering.

IN USE specify implementation support

support tier

A defined level of assistance with stated coverage and conditions.

IN USE compare support tiers

SLA

Service-level agreement; specified service commitments and their conditions.

IN USE review the SLA

initial response

The first defined acknowledgment or engagement after a support request.

IN USE confirm initial-response terms

resolution time

Time to reach a defined completed fix or outcome.

IN USE distinguish resolution time

support window

The hours during which the stated support service operates.

IN USE check the support window

Precision check

Four support hours is not automatically four elapsed hours. The stated calendar counts only covered periods, and the precise counting rules still need checking. Initial response also differs from resolution; neither quote supplies a guaranteed time to fix every issue.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

business hour

An hour counted under a specified working-time calendar.

IN USE define business hours

elapsed time

Continuous clock time between two points.

IN USE distinguish elapsed time

holiday exclusion

A stated holiday period not included in a service calendar.

IN USE check holiday exclusions

severity level

A classification of issue impact under the relevant support rules.

IN USE confirm severity levels

subscription fee

A recurring charge for access during a defined term.

IN USE compare subscription fees

one-time fee

A charge incurred once for the specified item.

IN USE identify one-time fees

recurring charge

A cost that repeats under the agreed schedule.

IN USE separate recurring charges

unpriced item

Work or a service without a supplied price.

IN USE flag unpriced items

quote validity

The period and conditions under which an offer remains available.

IN USE confirm quote validity

cost normalization

Adjusting a comparison to a consistent scope, period, and basis.

IN USE perform cost normalization

selection criterion

A factor used by the buyer to evaluate offers.

IN USE clarify selection criteria

commercial clarification

A question resolving an ambiguity in the offer's terms or price.

IN USE request commercial clarification

Precision check

The competitor headline is \$10,000 lower, which should be acknowledged directly. A complete like-for-like cost comparison is still unavailable because implementation support is unpriced and service terms differ. Do not replace an incomplete comparison with an unsupported claim that either supplier has lower total cost.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

ACKNOWLEDGE THE PRICE DIFFERENCE

"Their headline quote is ten thousand dollars lower."

COMPARE SCOPE

"Our offer includes ten implementation-support hours; theirs excludes that work."

AVOID AN INVENTED TOTAL

"We cannot complete the like-for-like cost comparison yet."

STATE THE CALENDAR

"The stated window is weekdays from nine to five Eastern, with listed holiday exclusions."

ASK WHAT MATTERS

"Which support coverage and implementation help do you actually need?"

KEEP THE GAP EXPLICIT

"We do not yet have a price for their implementation support."

CLARIFY THE RESPONSE TERM

"Four support hours refers to initial response, not guaranteed resolution."

DISTINGUISH CLOCK TIME

"Support hours are not the same as continuous elapsed hours."

Headline quote

Acknowledges the supplied price while leaving wider costs open.

Includes / excludes

Makes a scope difference concrete.

Do not yet have

Identifies missing information without inventing a disadvantage.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

CHECK OVERNIGHT NEEDS

"Your overnight requirement is not covered by this quoted window."

ASK FOR COMPARABLE TERMS

"Let us compare the service calendars and what counts as an initial response."

AVOID COMPETITOR SPECULATION

"We should evaluate the written offer rather than guess at their service quality."

RESPECT THE BUYER'S CHOICE

"The preferred offer depends on your requirements and the complete terms."

AVOID OVERCLAIMING

"I cannot describe this package as round-the-clock support."

KEEP SEVERITY VISIBLE

"Check whether different issue severities have different commitments."

REQUEST A CLARIFICATION

"Please obtain the missing implementation price and coverage details."

CLOSE THE COMPARISON

"We will put the prices, inclusions, exclusions, and unresolved items side by side."

Initial, not resolution

Separates two service events often confused in conversation.

Not covered

States a limitation of the seller's own offer honestly.

Written offer

Uses verifiable terms rather than a negative story about a competitor.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which competitive statement is supported?

- A** Their headline is \$10,000 lower, but equivalent-scope total cost is not yet established.
- B** Their total cost must be lower in every case.
- C** Their product must be unreliable because it costs less.
- D** Our higher headline guarantees a better customer outcome.

2. What does the four-support-hour term establish?

- A** A stated initial-response commitment under the specified service calendar
- B** Resolution within four continuous hours at any time
- C** Round-the-clock staffing
- D** Guaranteed correction of every issue before morning

3. How should Luis respond to overnight needs?

- A** Acknowledge that the quoted window does not cover them and check appropriate options.
- B** Describe weekday service as twenty-four-seven.
- C** Ignore the requirement because his offer costs more.
- D** Promise a different package without checking availability or terms.

4. What would improve the comparison?

- A** A priced equivalent implementation scope and clarified service calendars
- B** Removing the competitor's lower price from the table
- C** Assuming every business day is identical across suppliers
- D** Counting response and resolution as the same event

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The lower headline price covers a different package

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

initial response / support window / like-for-like comparison / commercial clarification / Elapsed time / headline price / cost normalization / unpriced item / selection criterion / severity levels

- 01 **Daria:** Your annual offer is forty-two thousand dollars. The competitor quoted thirty-two thousand, so I need to understand why we should pay ten thousand more.
- 02 **Luis:** Their ¹ _____ is lower, and that difference matters. May we compare the included work and support terms against what you need, rather than assume the two packages are identical?
- 03 **Daria:** Your proposal includes ten implementation-support hours. Their quote says implementation is separate, but I do not have the additional price yet.
- 04 **Luis:** Then that is an ² _____. We should keep it visible rather than invent an amount that makes our package look better. We cannot finish the equivalent-scope calculation until the missing price is supplied.
- 05 **Daria:** I also see four-hour support in your summary and next-business-day response in theirs. Does yours mean every issue will be fixed within four hours?
- 06 **Luis:** No. The term concerns ³ _____, not guaranteed resolution. We should correct any summary that leaves that distinction unclear, and check exactly what each offer counts as its first response.
- 07 **Daria:** We sometimes have an issue overnight. Would the four hours start counting from the time we contact support in the middle of the night?
- 08 **Luis:** We need to apply the stated ⁴ _____. This package covers Monday to Friday, nine to five Eastern, excluding listed holidays. It does not provide round-the-clock coverage, and the precise counting rules need checking.
- 09 **Daria:** So four support hours could extend across more than four hours on the clock if some of that time is outside the covered window.
- 10 **Luis:** Correct. ⁵ _____ and counted support hours are different. I should not imply that an overnight request is guaranteed a response or a completed fix within four continuous hours.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Daria:** The overnight requirement could be more important to us than the faster response during the ordinary working day.
- 12 **Luis:** Then make that a ⁶ _____. We need to check suitable coverage options and their actual terms. The package in front of us does not meet that requirement simply because its headline response is shorter.
- 13 **Daria:** I do not want the comparison to turn into claims that the competitor is poor quality. We have not evaluated their service yet.
- 14 **Luis:** Agreed. A ⁷ _____ should use the written offers. Different terms do not establish poor reliability or make a lower price evidence of inferior performance.
- 15 **Daria:** We should also check which issues the response commitments apply to and whether the suppliers classify severity in the same way.
- 16 **Luis:** Yes, compare the ⁸ _____ and relevant conditions. A shared label does not necessarily mean the same impact threshold or entitlement, so any mismatch belongs in the comparison.
- 17 **Daria:** Once we have the implementation price and the relevant support option, we can compare costs for a consistent period.
- 18 **Luis:** That will support ⁹ _____. Separate one-time and recurring charges, define the period, and check quote validity. Do not call the headline subscription amount the complete ownership cost.
- 19 **Daria:** Please send a table with the known prices, coverage, inclusions, and missing answers. I will ask the competitor for the implementation detail.
- 20 **Luis:** I will record each ¹⁰ _____ and our own coverage gap. Then you can judge the offers against your requirements with the remaining uncertainty visible, rather than hear an unsupported claim that either total is already lower.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. headline price | 2. unpriced item | 3. initial response | 4. support window | 5. Elapsed time | 6. selection criterion | 7. like-for-like comparison | 8. severity levels | 9. cost normalization | 10. commercial clarification

Keep another quote comparison accurate

F Say it

Offer A costs \$28,000 annually and includes onboarding. Offer B costs \$22,000 annually but excludes onboarding, whose price is unknown. Both state initial response rather than guaranteed resolution.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

initial response / not yet established / \$6,000 / onboarding service

Buyer: "The headline annual difference is ¹ _____."

Seller: "Offer B has an unpriced ² _____."

Buyer: "The support promise concerns ³ _____."

Seller: "Equivalent-scope total cost is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. \$6,000 | 2. onboarding service | 3. initial response | 4. not yet established

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Calculate the request without approving it

A Read the situation

Calculate the requested discount and explain its approval status, price base, and review process accurately.

A quote covers 100 licenses for 12 months at an \$80,000 subscription fee plus a separate \$4,000 setup fee. Buyer Matt requests a 15% reduction on the subscription only, leaving setup unchanged. That request would reduce subscription by \$12,000 to \$68,000, making the pre-tax first-year total \$72,000. Seller Alina may approve at most 5% under the stated standard terms; 15% requires the commercial director. No exception is approved. Alina promises a status update by Thursday at 16:00 local time. The existing quote remains valid until 31 October, without a fabricated earlier deadline.

PEOPLE / Matt: Buyer | Alina: Account executive

A CALCULATION IS NOT A COMMERCIAL PROMISE

Buyers may hear a clearly stated revised number as an offer unless its status is explicit. Name it as the requested or illustrative amount, then explain the approval route. A firm limit can remain helpful when the seller gives a specific next step and a reliable update time.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the base for the requested 15% reduction?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Only the \$4,000 setup fee | B An unspecified future renewal amount |
| C The \$80,000 subscription fee only | D The full \$84,000 including setup |

2. What would the requested pre-tax first-year total be?

- | | |
|-------------------|--|
| A \$71,400 | B \$84,000 after a 15% subscription reduction |
| C \$72,000 | D \$68,000 including setup |

3. Can Alina approve the 15% request?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A Yes; calculating it approves it. | B Yes; the buyer's request overrides the limit. |
| C No; it requires the commercial director. | D Yes; her limit is 15%. |

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

list price

A stated standard price before the relevant discounts.

IN USE confirm the list price

price book

A controlled source of product prices and related pricing entries.

IN USE use the approved price book

discount base

The amount to which a percentage reduction applies.

IN USE identify the discount base

discount amount

The monetary reduction from the specified base.

IN USE calculate the discount amount

net price

The price after the specified reductions, with inclusions and taxes clarified.

IN USE state the net price

subscription term

The period covered by the access agreement.

IN USE confirm the subscription term

setup fee

A charge for defined initial setup work.

IN USE separate the setup fee

pre-tax total

The amount before applicable taxes are included.

IN USE calculate the pre-tax total

approval threshold

A limit above which a different authorization is required.

IN USE check the approval threshold

delegated authority

Decision power assigned to a role within stated limits.

IN USE stay within delegated authority

pricing exception

A proposed departure from standard pricing conditions.

IN USE request a pricing exception

deal desk

A commercial support function coordinating complex terms and approvals.

IN USE consult the deal desk

Precision check

Fifteen percent of \$80,000 is \$12,000. The requested subscription becomes \$68,000; adding the unchanged \$4,000 setup charge gives \$72,000 before tax. Applying 15% to the entire \$84,000 would use the wrong base for this request.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

CPQ

Configure, price, quote; tools or processes for preparing structured commercial offers.

IN USE update the CPQ record

approval workflow

The required sequence for reviewing and authorizing a request.

IN USE follow the approval workflow

concession

A term or benefit offered during negotiation.

IN USE evaluate a concession

give-get

A negotiated exchange of a concession for a specified reciprocal commitment.

IN USE document the give-get

payment terms

Conditions governing when and how amounts are paid.

IN USE confirm payment terms

prepayment

Payment before the specified service or billing period.

IN USE assess a prepayment option

contract term

The duration or another defined condition of an agreement, depending on context.

IN USE clarify the contract term

ACV

Annual contract value, calculated under the organization's stated inclusion rules.

IN USE define ACV consistently

TCV

Total contract value over the specified term, with included charges defined.

IN USE calculate TCV

margin

A profit measure relative to revenue under a specified cost basis.

IN USE assess margin impact

quote validity

The period for which the quoted terms remain open under their conditions.

IN USE preserve quote validity

approved quote

An offer authorized through the relevant internal process.

IN USE issue an approved quote

Precision check

Price reduction and margin reduction are not the same measure. No cost information is supplied, so a profit-margin effect cannot be calculated from the discount alone. The \$72,000 figure is the requested scenario, not an approved offer or a tax-inclusive total.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CONFIRM THE REQUEST

"You are asking for fifteen percent off the subscription only."

SHOW THE AMOUNT

"Fifteen percent of that base is twelve thousand dollars."

KEEP SETUP SEPARATE

"The four-thousand-dollar setup fee remains unchanged."

LIMIT AUTHORITY

"My approval limit is five percent under these standard terms."

STATE THE BASE

"The discount base is eighty thousand dollars."

STATE THE CONDITIONAL PRICE

"The requested subscription would be sixty-eight thousand dollars."

STATE THE TOTAL ACCURATELY

"The requested first-year total would be seventy-two thousand before tax."

NAME THE APPROVER

"The fifteen-percent exception requires the commercial director."

Only

Identifies which charge receives the percentage reduction.

Would be

Keeps the arithmetic conditional on the requested concession.

Before tax

Defines what the total excludes.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP THE STATUS EXPLICIT

"This is a request under review, not an approved revised quote."

EXPLAIN OTHER OPTIONS CAREFULLY

"A change to term or payment timing would need its own assessment and approval."

PRESERVE THE REAL DEADLINE

"The existing quote is valid until the thirty-first of October."

COMMIT TO COMMUNICATION

"I will update you by Thursday at sixteen hundred local time."

AVOID A GUARANTEED OUTCOME

"I can submit the request, but I cannot promise approval."

AVOID SILENT STACKING

"We should not combine concessions without checking the complete package."

REJECT MANUFACTURED URGENCY

"I will not describe an earlier cutoff that is not in the offer."

CLOSE WITH THE RIGHT DOCUMENT

"Any approved change will appear in the revised authorized quote."

My limit

States the seller's actual authority.

Under review

Describes process status rather than approval.

Any approved change

Makes the revised offer conditional on authorization.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which calculation matches the request?

- A** \$80,000 plus a 15% surcharge
- B** \$80,000 minus \$12,000, plus \$4,000 setup, equals \$72,000 before tax.
- C** \$84,000 multiplied by 85%, with setup discounted too
- D** \$68,000 including a waived setup fee

2. Which status statement avoids a premature commitment?

- A** Approval is guaranteed once the request enters the system.
- B** The setup fee has disappeared without agreement.
- C** The requested total would be \$72,000 before tax, subject to the required approval.
- D** Your approved total is \$72,000 because I calculated it.

3. What is promised for Thursday at 16:00?

- A** A guaranteed director decision
- B** A status update
- C** Approval of the exception
- D** A signed customer contract

4. Which deadline should be communicated?

- A** The existing 31 October quote-validity date
- B** An invented earlier cutoff to pressure the buyer
- C** No deadline because the request changes every term automatically
- D** A guaranteed renewal price forever

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

Calculate the request without approving it

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

discount amount / pre-tax total / approval workflow / discount base / approved quote / pricing exception / give-get / payment terms / delegated authority / quote validity

- 01 **Matt:** We need fifteen percent off the subscription to make this proposal workable. The setup fee can stay as quoted.
- 02 **Alina:** Let me confirm the ¹ _____. You mean the eighty-thousand-dollar subscription for one hundred licenses over twelve months, with the four-thousand-dollar setup charge unchanged.
- 03 **Matt:** Correct. Please show me what that would mean for the first-year amount, so I can explain the request internally.
- 04 **Alina:** The ² _____ would be twelve thousand dollars. That brings the requested subscription to sixty-eight thousand, before adding the unchanged setup fee. I am calculating the request, not approving it.
- 05 **Matt:** So the total for the first year would be seventy-two thousand. Does that number include tax?
- 06 **Alina:** No, it is the ³ _____. It combines sixty-eight thousand in subscription and four thousand in setup. We should keep that scope clear when you share the calculation.
- 07 **Matt:** Can you approve that reduction now, or does somebody else need to decide?
- 08 **Alina:** My ⁴ _____ is limited to five percent under these standard terms. The fifteen-percent request requires the commercial director, so I cannot issue it as an approved offer today.
- 09 **Matt:** Please send it for review. I do not want the team to mistake your calculation for a price we can already accept.
- 10 **Alina:** I will label it as a ⁵ _____ under review. The amount and requested scope will be explicit, along with the fact that no exception approval has been granted.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Matt:** Would a longer term or earlier payment help? I am open to options, but I cannot commit to those changes without our own review.
- 12 **Alina:** We can assess the relevant ⁶ _____ or term alternatives. They are separate commercial choices, not automatic ways to secure the same discount. Any proposed exchange needs to be clear and approved on both sides.
- 13 **Matt:** I also do not want several concessions added together without knowing which condition goes with each one.
- 14 **Alina:** Agreed. Any ⁷ _____ must identify the actual exchange. We should assess the whole package and avoid stacking a discount, a term change, and different payment timing as though each were independently approved.
- 15 **Matt:** A colleague mentioned that this offer might expire before Friday. The written quote says the thirty-first of October.
- 16 **Alina:** The stated ⁸ _____ remains the thirty-first of October. I will not introduce an earlier deadline that is not in the offer or use an unsupported cutoff to rush your decision.
- 17 **Matt:** When will I hear back? I need a reliable update even if the director has not reached a decision.
- 18 **Alina:** I will update you by Thursday at sixteen hundred local time on the ⁹ _____. That is a status commitment, not a promise that the exception will be approved by then.
- 19 **Matt:** Once a decision is made, please make sure the document shows exactly which charges, conditions, and dates have changed.
- 20 **Alina:** Any authorized change will appear in the ¹⁰ _____. Until then, the seventy-two-thousand pre-tax amount is the requested scenario, and the existing offer remains subject to its stated terms.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. discount base | 2. discount amount | 3. pre-tax total | 4. delegated authority | 5. pricing exception | 6. payment terms | 7. give-get | 8. quote validity | 9. approval workflow | 10. approved quote

Calculate another request without approving it

F Say it

A quote has a \$50,000 subscription and an unchanged \$3,000 setup fee. The buyer requests 10% off subscription only. The seller cannot approve that exception; the required decision is pending.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

\$48,000 / \$50,000 / \$5,000 / pending

Seller: "The discount base is ¹ _____."

Buyer: "The requested discount amount is ² _____."

Seller: "The requested total before tax would be ³ _____."

Buyer: "The approval status is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. \$50,000 | 2. \$5,000 | 3. \$48,000 | 4. pending

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A supportive contact is not the whole buying process

A Read the situation

05

Map purchase roles, criteria, and sequence while respecting the main contact and separating interest from authorization.

Operations manager Devon is enthusiastic about Rosa's proposal and can explain the workflow need. He does not control the budget or hold contract-signing authority. The finance director owns budget approval, procurement owns vendor onboarding, and an information-security review is required. The authorized contract signer has not been identified. None of these reviews has started. Rosa must work with Devon to identify owners, criteria, sequence, and realistic access to the other participants. Enthusiasm is not an approved purchase, and a favorable demonstration is not a completed security review.

PEOPLE / Devon: Prospect operations manager | Rosa: Account executive

BROADEN THE CONVERSATION WITHOUT BYPASSING THE CONTACT

A main contact can feel sidelined when a seller suddenly approaches senior colleagues without context. Explain which decisions require other roles and agree how to involve them. A buying-role map should support a transparent evaluation, not encourage secret pressure or treat people as obstacles to be manipulated.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What can Devon contribute?

- A** The workflow need and operational evaluation context
- C** Contract signature on behalf of the organization

- B** Independent approval of the budget
- D** Completion of security review by enthusiasm

2. Who owns vendor onboarding?

- A** Any end user who attended the demonstration
- C** Devon alone

- B** Procurement
- D** The seller's marketing team

3. Which authority is still unidentified?

- A** Whether security review is required
- C** The owner of budget approval

- B** The authorized contract signer
- D** The team responsible for vendor onboarding

Answers and explanations: page 84.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

buying committee

The people participating in evaluating and authorizing a purchase.

IN USE map the buying committee

economic buyer

A person with the relevant overall spending decision authority under the buying arrangement.

IN USE identify the economic buyer

champion

An influential internal advocate who actively supports a proposal.

IN USE verify the champion's role

coach

A contact who helps explain the organization or process without necessarily having strong influence.

IN USE learn from a coach

influencer

A person shaping a decision without necessarily holding approval authority.

IN USE understand the influencer

end user

A person expected to use the proposed product or service.

IN USE involve end users

procurement

The function managing specified purchasing and supplier processes.

IN USE engage procurement

gatekeeper

A role controlling access or a required process step.

IN USE understand the gatekeeper's requirements

budget approval

Authorization for the relevant allocation or use of funds.

IN USE obtain budget approval

decision criteria

The factors used by the buyer to judge options.

IN USE confirm decision criteria

decision process

The steps and roles used to choose an option.

IN USE map the decision process

paper process

The administrative and contractual steps leading from a decision to signature.

IN USE clarify the paper process

Precision check

Budget approval, vendor onboarding, security review, and contract signature are different steps. The same person may hold several roles in some organizations, but that cannot be assumed here. Devon supports the operational need and does not hold the stated commercial authorities.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

authorized signer

A person empowered to execute the relevant agreement.

IN USE identify the authorized signer

stakeholder map

A record of relevant people, roles, concerns, and responsibilities.

IN USE maintain the stakeholder map

stakeholder alignment

Shared understanding of the proposal and relevant decision requirements.

IN USE build stakeholder alignment

single-threaded

Dependent on one contact or relationship in an account.

IN USE identify a single-threaded opportunity

multi-threaded

Engaging multiple relevant roles in an account.

IN USE develop a multi-threaded engagement

access path

An agreed way to involve or communicate with a relevant person.

IN USE agree an access path

executive sponsor

A senior person supporting an initiative within their role.

IN USE confirm the executive sponsor

technical win

Informal sales language for favorable technical evaluation, not necessarily purchase approval.

IN USE distinguish a technical win

commercial approval

Authorization of the relevant business or financial terms.

IN USE confirm commercial approval

vendor onboarding

Steps needed to establish a supplier in the buyer's systems and processes.

IN USE complete vendor onboarding

security review

Assessment of relevant information-security requirements.

IN USE coordinate the security review

stakeholder concern

A requirement or issue raised by someone involved in the decision.

IN USE address stakeholder concerns

Precision check

Champion, coach, technical win, and paper process are common sales shorthand. Use them carefully in internal discussions and translate them into actual responsibilities with customers. An enthusiastic contact is not necessarily an influential advocate, and a technical preference is not a signed purchase.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

RECOGNIZE THE SUPPORT

"Your understanding of the workflow will help us make the evaluation relevant."

ASK ABOUT BUDGET

"Who approves the relevant funding?"

KEEP SECURITY DISTINCT

"A product demonstration does not complete the required security review."

MAP THE SEQUENCE

"Which reviews can run together, and which depend on an earlier decision?"

CLARIFY THE CONTACT ROLE

"Which decisions do you own, and which require other colleagues?"

ASK ABOUT PROCUREMENT

"What vendor-onboarding steps need to happen?"

IDENTIFY SIGNATURE AUTHORITY

"Who is authorized to sign the agreement?"

ASK ABOUT CRITERIA

"What does each group need to establish before it can support the purchase?"

Which decisions

Clarifies role boundaries without questioning the contact's value.

Need to establish

Connects each reviewer to a relevant requirement.

How would you prefer

Seeks an agreed introduction rather than bypassing the contact.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID ASSUMING A CHAMPION

"I do not want to infer your internal authority from your interest in the proposal."

PRESERVE THE MAIN CONTACT

"We can keep you included as we address the other teams' questions."

KEEP PROGRESS FACTUAL

"None of the budget, onboarding, or security reviews has started yet."

PLAN JOINTLY

"Let us agree owners and realistic next actions with the relevant teams."

AGREE ACCESS RESPECTFULLY

"How would you prefer us to involve the relevant colleagues?"

DISTINGUISH TECHNICAL PREFERENCE

"A favorable technical evaluation does not by itself approve commercial terms."

AVOID A SIGNATURE PROMISE

"We cannot confirm a signing date before understanding the required steps."

CLOSE THE MAP

"I will separate known roles, unconfirmed authority, review status, and next steps."

Does not by itself

Prevents one favorable review being inflated into complete approval.

Has started

Describes actual process progress rather than intention.

Unconfirmed authority

Keeps a missing role visible until it is verified.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which internal account note is accurate?

- A** Devon supports the need; budget, procurement, security, and signer steps remain unresolved.
- B** Devon's enthusiasm means the purchase is approved.
- C** The demonstration completed the security review.
- D** The finance director must be the signer because the title sounds senior.

2. Which question broadens access respectfully?

- A** How can we involve the relevant reviewers while keeping you included?
- B** May I tell your director that you have already approved the purchase?
- C** Can we conceal the security requirement to move faster?
- D** Who can we bypass without telling you?

3. What does a technical win establish in this context?

- A** A favorable technical assessment, not necessarily budget or contract approval
- B** A completed signed contract
- C** Automatic onboarding
- D** Guaranteed authority for every end user

4. What should the role map distinguish?

- A** Only people who favor the seller
- B** A presumed signature date without process evidence
- C** Owners, evaluation criteria, sequence, current status, and unknown authority
- D** Job titles alone

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

A supportive contact is not the whole buying process

E Conversations / turns 1-10

05

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

stakeholder map / authorized signer / security review / decision criteria / budget approval / vendor onboarding / paper process / decision process / buying committee / access path

- 01 **Devon:** The proposal fits the workflow problem we discussed, and I would like to take it forward. I am not sure what your team needs from us next.
- 02 **Rosa:** Let us map the ¹ _____ to identify the reviewers and their decisions. Your support is helpful, but I should not assume that you own every approval.
- 03 **Devon:** I coordinate the operational need, but I do not control the budget. The finance director owns the funding approval.
- 04 **Rosa:** Then we should identify the relevant ² _____ requirements with that role. We need to know what evidence the director expects and how the funding decision relates to the wider purchase process.
- 05 **Devon:** Procurement handles setting up new vendors. I have not contacted them about this proposal yet.
- 06 **Rosa:** Their ³ _____ steps should be visible in the plan. We should ask about the required information and timing rather than assume that a favorable operational review gets a supplier into the system automatically.
- 07 **Devon:** Information security also needs to assess the offering. The demonstration was useful, but it was not that assessment.
- 08 **Rosa:** Correct. A ⁴ _____ has its own requirements and owner. We can arrange the appropriate information exchange without presenting a successful demonstration as clearance to purchase or deploy.
- 09 **Devon:** I do not know who signs the eventual agreement. It may not be the same person who approves the budget.
- 10 **Rosa:** We need to confirm the ⁵ _____. A title or budget role is not enough to infer contract authority. We can leave that field unconfirmed until the relevant person or process establishes it.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Devon:** There are more steps than I had considered. Some might be able to run together, while others probably depend on a decision first.
- 12 **Rosa:** That is why the ⁶ _____ matters. Ask the owners which activities can proceed together and what each one needs before starting, rather than impose a seller timeline on an unknown process.
- 13 **Devon:** Once the organization decides to buy, there may still be contract and purchasing steps before anyone can sign.
- 14 **Rosa:** Sales teams sometimes call that the ⁷ _____. With your colleagues, we should name the actual documents, reviews, and authorities. The shorthand should not hide work that remains after a preferred option is selected.
- 15 **Devon:** I am happy to introduce the right people, but I would like to stay involved rather than suddenly find that conversations have moved around me.
- 16 **Rosa:** Let us agree the ⁸ _____ with you. We can explain why each colleague is needed, keep you included, and focus the conversations on their requirements rather than ask everyone to attend an unfocused sales meeting.
- 17 **Devon:** Some people will care most about the workflow, while others need cost, security, or supplier information. We should not assume they judge the same thing.
- 18 **Rosa:** Record those ⁹ _____ explicitly. That helps us address substantive questions and understand disagreement without labeling every person who asks for evidence an obstacle.
- 19 **Devon:** Please send a map showing the known roles and the gaps. I will help identify the right owners and discuss a realistic next meeting.
- 20 **Rosa:** I will update the ¹⁰ _____. Budget, onboarding, and security reviews have not started, and the signer is unconfirmed. We can plan next steps without inventing purchase approval or a signing date.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. buying committee | 2. budget approval | 3. vendor onboarding | 4. security review | 5. authorized signer | 6. decision process | 7. paper process | 8. access path | 9. decision criteria | 10. stakeholder map

Separate another set of buying roles

F Say it

A department lead supports a proposal. Finance approves funding, procurement registers suppliers, and a technical team evaluates compatibility. The contract signer remains unknown, and no purchase is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

procurement / unknown / technical team / finance

Seller: "The funding role belongs to ¹ _____."

Lead: "Supplier registration belongs to ² _____."

Seller: "Compatibility is evaluated by the ³ _____."

Lead: "The contract signer remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. finance | 2. procurement | 3. technical team | 4. unknown

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes

A Read the situation

Route the exact proposed contract change for review without accepting it or promising a legal outcome.

06

Buyer Priya returns agreement version 4 with a proposed change to clause 10.2, removing a stated liability cap and requesting uncapped liability. She asks seller Marcus to accept it today. The company requires legal review and authorized commercial approval for this change; Marcus holds neither authority. No response wording has been approved. Marcus must preserve the marked document, clarify the business concern for counsel, and track the review. He promises a status update at 16:00 Eastern today, not acceptance. The effect of the clause depends on the complete agreement and relevant law, which the exercise does not determine.

PEOPLE / Priya: Buyer coordinating contract comments | Marcus: Account executive

KEEP THE COMMERCIAL RELATIONSHIP MOVING WITHOUT ACTING AS COUNSEL

A buyer asking for an immediate answer may be trying to meet an internal deadline rather than dismiss the review process. Acknowledge that pressure, identify the exact question, and provide a reliable update. Do not create apparent acceptance to preserve momentum or give an unsupported view of enforceability.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What change has the buyer proposed?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Removing the stated liability cap in clause 10.2 of version 4 | B Approving the unchanged contract |
| C Reducing only the subscription price | D Confirming that all legal review is complete |

2. Can Marcus accept the wording?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Yes; version 4 is automatically final. | B No; he lacks the required legal and commercial approval authority. |
| C Yes; receiving a redline approves it. | D Yes; the buyer's deadline transfers authority. |

3. What is promised at 16:00 Eastern?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A Acceptance of uncapped liability | B A guarantee of enforceability |
| C A signed agreement from both parties | D A review-status update |

Answers and explanations: page 86.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

redline

A document showing proposed changes to existing wording.

IN USE review the redline

markup

Visible additions, deletions, or comments in a document.

IN USE preserve the markup

clean version

A version without visible change marks, whose approval status still needs checking.

IN USE reconcile the clean version

version control

Identification and management of document revisions.

IN USE maintain version control

contract clause

A defined provision within an agreement.

IN USE identify the contract clause

liability cap

A stated limit on specified liability, subject to the wording and applicable law.

IN USE review the liability cap

uncapped liability

Liability without the specified contractual cap, subject to the full legal context.

IN USE assess proposed uncapped liability

indemnity

An obligation concerning compensation for specified losses under the relevant terms.

IN USE review the indemnity

warranty

A contractual assurance with meaning and remedies determined by the relevant terms and law.

IN USE clarify the warranty

representation

A statement of fact whose legal effect depends on context and applicable law.

IN USE review the representation

governing law

The law identified or determined as applicable to an agreement or issue.

IN USE confirm governing law

jurisdiction

The relevant authority or forum's legal power over a matter.

IN USE review jurisdiction terms

Precision check

Receiving a marked agreement means a proposal has arrived; it does not mean the changed clause is accepted. A clean version can also contain unapproved wording. Keep document status, review status, commercial approval, and signature status distinct.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

carve-out

An exception to a stated contractual rule or limitation.

IN USE identify a carve-out

consequential loss

A category of loss whose scope depends on applicable law and contract interpretation.

IN USE refer consequential-loss wording

third-party claim

A claim made by someone outside the contracting parties.

IN USE assess third-party claims

MSA

Master services agreement; overarching terms governing specified services or later orders.

IN USE review the MSA

order form

A document setting out the specific purchase and related terms.

IN USE reconcile the order form

DPA

Data processing agreement or addendum governing specified processing arrangements.

IN USE route the DPA for review

approved fallback

Alternative wording authorized for defined circumstances.

IN USE check the approved fallback

escalation

Routing an issue to the appropriate authority or specialist.

IN USE escalate the redline

authorized signatory

A person empowered to sign the relevant agreement.

IN USE verify the authorized signatory

signature workflow

The agreed steps for approving and executing the contract.

IN USE confirm the signature workflow

negotiating position

A proposed stance on terms, distinct from a final agreement.

IN USE clarify the negotiating position

acceptance

Assent to proposed terms, with legal effect determined by the relevant circumstances.

IN USE avoid unintended acceptance

06

Precision check

The exercise supplies an approval process, not enough information to determine the clause effect or enforceability. Do not treat capped, uncapped, indemnity, or carve-out as self-contained legal conclusions. The full text, related terms, and applicable law require the relevant qualified review.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE RECEIPT

"I have received your marked version four."

CONFIRM THE REQUEST

"You are asking to remove the stated liability cap."

EXPLAIN AUTHORITY

"This change requires legal review and authorized commercial approval."

CLARIFY THE CONCERN

"What business concern should I include when routing the request to counsel?"

IDENTIFY THE CHANGE

"The proposed change is to clause ten point two."

PRESERVE THE STATUS

"I am acknowledging the proposal, not accepting the wording."

AVOID AN IMPROVISED LEGAL ANSWER

"I cannot determine the clause's effect or enforceability."

KEEP THE TEXT INTACT

"I will send the full marked agreement, not a paraphrase of the clause alone."

Received

Confirms delivery without stating agreement.

Proposed

Keeps the change distinct from an accepted term.

Not accepting

Removes ambiguity from the acknowledgment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK RELATED TERMS

"The reviewers need the complete document and relevant cross-references."

TRACK THE VERSION

"Any response should identify the version and changes clearly."

PROMISE COMMUNICATION

"I will update you at sixteen hundred Eastern today."

RECONCILE BEFORE SIGNATURE

"The final clean text must match the authorized negotiated position."

AVOID A PROMISED FALLBACK

"No alternative wording has been approved for this request yet."

SEPARATE URGENCY AND APPROVAL

"I understand the deadline, but it does not change the required authority."

KEEP UNCERTAINTY HONEST

"That update may report that the review is still pending."

CLOSE WITHOUT APPARENT ASSENT

"The proposed change remains under review until the required decision is communicated."

Business concern

Gives reviewers context without asking the seller to supply legal advice.

Full marked agreement

Preserves exact wording and its surrounding terms.

May report pending

Makes the update promise realistic rather than a hidden promise of approval.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which acknowledgment preserves the actual status?

- A** I received version 4; clause 10.2 remains under the required review and is not accepted.
- B** Agreed, although I have no authority.
- C** The clean file proves everyone approved it.
- D** The buyer's deadline makes the clause enforceable.

2. What should Marcus send for review?

- A** The full marked agreement with the exact version and business concern
- B** A memory-based paraphrase with the original deleted
- C** Only an unsigned sentence separated from every cross-reference
- D** A message saying approval already exists

3. What can Marcus responsibly promise today?

- A** A signature from an unidentified authorized person
- B** A status update at 16:00 Eastern
- C** Automatic approval of the buyer's wording
- D** A favorable legal conclusion

4. Which check belongs before signature?

- A** Reconcile the clean text with the authorized negotiated version.
- B** Assume all clean documents are approved.
- C** Delete the change history before reviewers compare it.
- D** Treat an email acknowledgment as the final executed agreement.

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

A customer redline needs review, not an immediate yes

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

authorized signatory / liability cap / approved fallback / negotiating position / version control / redline / markup / uncapped liability / clean version / escalation

- 01 **Priya:** I have returned version four with changes to clause ten point two. We need you to accept the removal of the liability cap today.
- 02 **Marcus:** I have received the ¹ _____. I am acknowledging the proposal, not accepting the wording. This change requires legal review and authorized commercial approval, neither of which I can provide myself.
- 03 **Priya:** Our team considers the existing cap too restrictive. Can you tell me whether removing it is legally necessary?
- 04 **Marcus:** I cannot determine the effect of the ² _____ or give that legal conclusion. I can make sure the reviewers receive your concern and the exact proposed text rather than an incomplete description.
- 05 **Priya:** We are asking for uncapped liability because the business team is concerned about losses beyond the current amount.
- 06 **Marcus:** I will pass that concern on with the proposed ³ _____ wording. The reviewers need the complete agreement and related provisions, not a conclusion from me about what the change would mean in every situation.
- 07 **Priya:** Please do not send only a summary saying that we want different risk terms. The exact wording matters to our team.
- 08 **Marcus:** Agreed. I will preserve the ⁴ _____ and identify version four clearly. A paraphrase could miss an exception, cross-reference, or other wording that changes the question the reviewers need to answer.
- 09 **Priya:** Could you offer your standard alternative now? That might avoid another round of discussion.
- 10 **Marcus:** No ⁵ _____ has been cleared for this request. I will ask whether an authorized alternative is available, but I should not invent one or suggest that a familiar phrase is automatically permitted.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Priya:** I understand the review requirement, but the timing is difficult. Our internal team expects an answer today.
- 12 **Marcus:** I understand. The ⁶ _____ will include that deadline and your business concern. Urgency helps the reviewers prioritize; it does not give me authority to accept terms before the required decision.
- 13 **Priya:** What can you commit to telling us today, even if the substantive answer is not ready?
- 14 **Marcus:** I will update you at sixteen hundred Eastern on the ⁷ _____ and review status. That may mean confirming that the review is still pending, not promising acceptance or a particular alternative by that time.
- 15 **Priya:** When a response is ready, please keep the changed document identifiable. We already have several files circulating.
- 16 **Marcus:** We will maintain ⁸ _____. Each response should show which version it addresses and what changed, so neither team treats an older file as the current negotiated text.
- 17 **Priya:** Our team will need a clean document for signature eventually, but I do not want clean formatting to hide a disagreement.
- 18 **Marcus:** Exactly. A ⁹ _____ must be reconciled with the authorized position. Removing markup is a formatting step, not evidence that the underlying terms have been approved.
- 19 **Priya:** Please confirm the signing route once the wording is actually agreed through the required process.
- 20 **Marcus:** We will verify the ¹⁰ _____ and signature workflow then. For now, the proposed clause change remains under review, and my next commitment is the status update at sixteen hundred Eastern.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. redline | 2. liability cap | 3. uncapped liability | 4. markup | 5. approved fallback | 6. escalation | 7. negotiating position | 8. version control | 9. clean version | 10. authorized signatory

Acknowledge another unapproved redline

F Say it

A buyer returns version 7 with a change to clause 8.3. The account executive cannot accept it and must obtain legal and authorized commercial review. The next status update is due at 11:00 Central.

06

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

11:00 Central / version 7 / acceptance / clause 8.3

Seller: "The received document is ¹ _____."

Buyer: "The changed provision is ² _____."

Seller: "Receipt does not mean ³ _____."

Buyer: "The promised status update is at ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. version 7 | 2. clause 8.3 | 3. acceptance | 4. 11:00 Central

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Define the partnership before promising exclusivity

A Read the situation

Define territory, products, duration, contribution, and funding before promising partnership rights.

Chen requests exclusivity without defining territory, products, duration, or contribution. Amina cannot grant it. For assessment, the team proposes a six-month nonexclusive scheduling-product pilot in fictional Region North, targeting four qualified opportunities per quarter. Qualification requires a customer need, relevant contact, and agreed next step, not an order. Chen requests \$5,000 marketing support; none is approved. All pilot terms require commercial and legal review.

PEOPLE / Chen: Potential channel partner | Amina: Channel development manager

07

PARTNERSHIP LANGUAGE CAN HIDE DIFFERENT EXPECTATIONS

Partner may mean joint marketing to one party and exclusive resale rights to another. Name the activities and responsibilities first. Shared ambition does not settle rights, targets, funding, or legal suitability.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is missing from the initial exclusivity request?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A An already approved exclusive contract | B A guaranteed customer order |
| C Defined territory, products, duration, and contribution | D The fact that Chen is interested |

2. What pilot is being considered?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Unlimited marketing funding | B A six-month nonexclusive scheduling-product pilot in Region North |
| C Permanent worldwide exclusivity for every product | D An already executed reseller agreement |

3. What does four qualified opportunities per quarter mean here?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Four signed orders guaranteed | B Four arbitrary names on a mailing list |
| C Four paid implementations | D Four opportunities meeting the stated need, contact, and next-step criteria |

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

channel partner

An organization helping market, sell, deliver, or support an offering under agreed terms.

IN USE develop a channel partner

referral partner

A partner introducing potential customers under the relevant arrangement.

IN USE define a referral partnership

reseller

A party selling another organization's offering under agreed rights and terms.

IN USE appoint a reseller

distributor

An intermediary supplying products to other sellers or channels under an arrangement.

IN USE work with a distributor

VAR

Value-added reseller; a reseller combining an offering with additional services or capabilities.

IN USE assess a VAR model

MSP

Managed service provider; a provider operating specified services for customers.

IN USE engage an MSP

ISV

Independent software vendor; a company developing and selling its own software.

IN USE coordinate an ISV partnership

co-selling

Seller and partner working together on a defined sales opportunity.

IN USE agree co-selling roles

partner enablement

Training, resources, and support preparing partners to perform agreed activities.

IN USE deliver partner enablement

territory

The defined geographic or account area covered by rights or activity.

IN USE define the territory

exclusivity

A restriction or sole right within specified boundaries, subject to agreement and law.

IN USE assess exclusivity terms

nonexclusive

Not granting a sole right within the stated arrangement.

IN USE propose a nonexclusive pilot

Precision check

A qualified opportunity is not a signed order. This pilot proposal uses three explicit conditions: identified need, relevant contact, and agreed next step. Four opportunities per quarter would measure pipeline contribution under that definition, not guaranteed bookings or cash receipts.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

product scope

The offerings included in the arrangement.

IN USE specify the product scope

term

The defined duration of an arrangement.

IN USE agree the pilot term

performance target

A specified level of contribution or result being sought.

IN USE define performance targets

qualified opportunity

A potential sale meeting the organization's explicit qualification conditions.

IN USE document qualified opportunities

deal registration

Recording a partner opportunity under the relevant channel process.

IN USE confirm deal registration

channel conflict

Overlap or disagreement between sales routes or partners.

IN USE manage channel conflict

attribution rule

A rule defining who receives credit for a contribution or result.

IN USE agree attribution rules

MDF

Market development funds; resources for specified partner marketing activity under approved terms.

IN USE request MDF

sell-in

Sales into a channel intermediary, under the relevant measurement definition.

IN USE measure sell-in

sell-through

Sales onward through the channel to the defined customer group.

IN USE track sell-through

support handoff

Transfer of responsibility for customer assistance between parties.

IN USE define the support handoff

renewal review

Assessment before deciding whether to continue an arrangement.

IN USE schedule a renewal review

Precision check

Nonexclusive describes proposed rights, not approval of the arrangement. Territory, products, duration, targets, support, funding, and review terms still need agreement. The \$5,000 request does not authorize spending on behalf of the seller.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE ACTIVITY

"Are you proposing referrals, resale, implementation, or a combination?"

STATE AUTHORITY

"I cannot grant exclusivity in this conversation."

STATE PRODUCT AND TERRITORY

"The proposal covers the scheduling product in Region North."

DEFINE CONTRIBUTION

"The target is four qualified opportunities per quarter."

DEFINE THE REQUEST

"What territory, products, duration, and contribution would the exclusive right cover?"

OFFER A BOUNDED ASSESSMENT

"We can assess a six-month nonexclusive pilot."

KEEP THE STATUS CLEAR

"These are proposed terms, not an executed agreement."

DEFINE QUALIFICATION

"Each opportunity needs an identified need, relevant contact, and agreed next step."

07

Are you proposing

Clarifies the relationship type before discussing rights.

Would cover

Treats exclusivity as a defined proposal rather than a vague privilege.

Can assess

Offers evaluation without granting authority.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A BOOKINGS CLAIM

"An opportunity target is not a guarantee of signed orders."

HANDLE OVERLAPPING ACCOUNTS

"We need rules for registration and channel conflict."

SEPARATE THE FUNDING REQUEST

"The five-thousand-dollar marketing request is not approved."

SET THE REVIEW

"Agree how results and continuation will be assessed at the end of the pilot."

PLAN ENABLEMENT

"What training and materials would support the agreed activities?"

CLARIFY CREDIT

"Agree how joint contributions will be attributed."

ASSIGN SUPPORT

"Define who handles customer questions and when responsibility transfers."

CLOSE RESPONSIBLY

"Submit the full proposal for the required commercial and legal review before promising rights or funding."

Each opportunity

Makes the contribution measure testable.

Not approved

Prevents a funding request becoming implied spending permission.

Full proposal

Keeps rights, obligations, targets, and resources together for review.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response handles exclusivity appropriately?

- A** Define the scope and contribution, then route the proposal for the required review without promising the right.
- B** Grant worldwide exclusivity because the partner sounds enthusiastic.
- C** Treat the word partner as a signed agreement.
- D** Approve every product and region without discussion.

2. Which item meets the supplied qualification definition?

- A** An assumed signed order without evidence
- B** A prospect with a stated need, relevant contact, and agreed next step
- C** A purchased email address with no known need
- D** A duplicate company name

3. How should the \$5,000 be described?

- A** An unapproved marketing-support request
- B** A reimbursement guaranteed before review
- C** Money already paid to the partner
- D** Automatic compensation for every introduction

4. What should a pilot agreement clarify beyond lead targets?

- A** Permanent exclusivity hidden under a pilot title
- B** Rights, product scope, territory, support roles, attribution, funding, and review
- C** Only a friendly label for the relationship
- D** Guaranteed revenue without customer orders

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

Define the partnership before promising exclusivity

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

nonexclusive / attribution rules / product scope / exclusivity / MDF / support handoff / qualified opportunity / channel partner / performance target / deal registration

07

- 01 **Chen:** We are interested in becoming your partner, but we would want exclusive rights before investing time in the relationship.
- 02 **Amina:** Let us define the ¹ _____ you have in mind. We have not identified the territory, products, duration, or contribution, and I cannot grant an exclusive right in this conversation.
- 03 **Chen:** We have experience introducing customers and helping with implementation. I have not decided whether we would also handle the commercial sale.
- 04 **Amina:** Then clarify the ² _____ activities first. Referrals, resale, and implementation are different roles. The proposal should say which you would perform and where our team would remain responsible.
- 05 **Chen:** A limited pilot could help us understand the relationship before either side makes a longer commitment.
- 06 **Amina:** We can assess a ³ _____ six-month pilot. That is a proposal for review, not an executed agreement or a promise that every later commercial request will be accepted.
- 07 **Chen:** For the pilot, Region North would match our current contacts. We would focus on the scheduling product rather than the full catalog.
- 08 **Amina:** That makes the ⁴ _____ and territory more concrete. We should record both, so the pilot is not later described as covering every product or a broader geographic area.
- 09 **Chen:** What contribution would you expect us to demonstrate during that period? I would prefer a measure we can understand and document.
- 10 **Amina:** The proposed ⁵ _____ is four qualified opportunities per quarter. We need a clear definition so the count reflects meaningful customer engagement rather than a list of names.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Chen:** We can identify a customer need, the relevant contact, and an agreed next conversation. That does not mean the customer has decided to buy.
- 12 **Amina:** Correct. A ⁶ _____ meets those three conditions in this proposal. It is not a signed order, and we should not turn the target into a promise of bookings or cash receipts.
- 13 **Chen:** Some prospects may already be talking with your direct sales team. We should avoid approaching them with conflicting offers.
- 14 **Amina:** We need a ⁷ _____ process and channel-conflict rules. Agree how overlapping accounts are handled and how each party learns the current status before making commitments to a customer.
- 15 **Chen:** Joint opportunities will also need a fair way to recognize who contributed. An introduction and implementation support are not the same activity.
- 16 **Amina:** Define the ⁸ _____ explicitly. Credit, customer communication, and any compensation should follow the agreed arrangement rather than a general claim that the account belongs to one side forever.
- 17 **Chen:** We would request five thousand dollars for marketing activity. Should we begin spending now and submit the receipts later?
- 18 **Amina:** No. The ⁹ _____ request is not approved. We need the activity, budget, conditions, and authorization assessed before you assume that our company will fund or reimburse it.
- 19 **Chen:** Before launch, we also need to know who supports customers and how we review the partnership at the end of the six months.
- 20 **Amina:** Include the ¹⁰ _____, enablement, and renewal-review arrangements in the full proposal. Then the required commercial and legal review can assess the actual relationship before anyone promises rights, spending, or ongoing commitments.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. exclusivity | 2. channel partner | 3. nonexclusive | 4. product scope | 5. performance target | 6. qualified opportunity | 7. deal registration | 8. attribution rules | 9. MDF | 10. support handoff

Describe another proposed channel pilot

F Say it

A proposed pilot is nonexclusive, lasts four months, covers the inventory product in Region West, and targets three qualified opportunities per quarter. No agreement or marketing funding has been approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

nonexclusive / three / four months / inventory product

Manager: "The proposed rights are ¹ _____."

Partner: "The proposed term is ² _____."

Manager: "The product scope is the ³ _____."

Partner: "The quarterly opportunity target is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. nonexclusive | 2. four months | 3. inventory product | 4. three

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The forecast date is the seller estimate, not a customer promise

A Read the situation

Correct stages, dates, amounts, and forecast confidence using customer evidence rather than seller hopes.

Opportunity H27 concerns a \$120,000 twelve-month subscription plus a separate \$20,000 setup fee. Seller Mika records 31 October as the close date, selects Contracting, and puts the deal in Commit. The customer has attended a demonstration and expressed interest, but procurement has not started and no signing date is confirmed. Under this fictional team policy, Contracting requires procurement to have started; Commit requires a customer-confirmed signing window and a documented approval path. Evaluation fits the demonstrated current status. Manager Jonas asks Mika to correct the record and verify buying steps with the customer by Monday at 14:00 Eastern.

PEOPLE / Mika: Account executive | Jonas: Sales manager

08

A FORECAST CORRECTION IS USEFUL INFORMATION

Sales pressure can make an evidence-based downgrade feel like personal failure. Treat the correction as a way to expose the next customer task and improve planning. Do not punish honesty by demanding an invented date or confuse removal from a commitment category with abandonment of the opportunity.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Who supplied the 31 October close date?

- A** Procurement approved it after completing review.
- B** Both parties signed an order with that date.
- C** Mika entered it as a seller estimate.
- D** The customer confirmed it as a signing commitment.

2. Why is Contracting unsupported under the stated policy?

- A** The subscription has no stated amount.
- B** Evaluation automatically means a lost deal.
- C** Procurement has not started.
- D** The customer never saw a demonstration.

3. What is Mika required to do by Monday at 14:00 Eastern?

- A** Delete the opportunity as lost
- B** Verify the buying steps with the customer
- C** Guarantee the signature
- D** Recognize all subscription revenue

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

CRM

Customer relationship management; systems and practices for maintaining customer and opportunity information.

IN USE update the CRM

opportunity

A potential sale tracked under the team's defined criteria.

IN USE maintain the opportunity record

stage exit criterion

Evidence required before an opportunity moves beyond a defined sales stage.

IN USE verify stage exit criteria

forecast category

A grouping indicating how a deal is treated in the forecast.

IN USE review the forecast category

Commit

A team's high-confidence forecast category, whose specific requirements must be defined.

IN USE substantiate Commit status

best case

A forecast scenario or category for possible outcomes under the team's rules.

IN USE qualify the best-case estimate

pipeline

The set of tracked potential sales and their progress.

IN USE review the pipeline

pipeline coverage

Potential pipeline value relative to a defined sales target or other stated basis.

IN USE define pipeline coverage

weighted pipeline

Opportunity values adjusted by assigned probabilities under a specified model.

IN USE interpret weighted pipeline

close date

The recorded expected or actual completion date, with its status specified.

IN USE verify the close date

buyer-confirmed date

A date explicitly confirmed by the relevant customer role for the stated event.

IN USE record a buyer-confirmed date

stage age

Time an opportunity has spent in its current stage.

IN USE monitor stage age

Precision check

The \$120,000 subscription and \$20,000 setup fee total \$140,000 before any unmentioned taxes or adjustments, but they are different charge types. A forecast field must identify what it includes. None of these quoted amounts is automatically a booking, cash receipt, or recognized revenue.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

sales velocity

A defined measure of how quickly sales opportunities generate results.

IN USE define sales velocity

slippage

Movement of an expected completion beyond the previously forecast period.

IN USE explain forecast slippage

stale opportunity

A deal record lacking current evidence or meaningful progress under the team's criteria.

IN USE review stale opportunities

next-step owner

The person responsible for a specified follow-up action.

IN USE identify the next-step owner

loss reason

The documented reason an opportunity did not proceed, where known.

IN USE record the loss reason

Closed Won

A completed-sale status used according to the organization's defined completion conditions.

IN USE verify Closed Won criteria

bookings

Contracted sales value measured under the organization's specified rules.

IN USE distinguish bookings

recognized revenue

Revenue recorded under the applicable accounting rules, distinct from forecasts or cash receipts.

IN USE separate recognized revenue

audit trail

A record of changes, sources, and decisions over time.

IN USE preserve the audit trail

forecast snapshot

A dated record of the forecast at a particular point.

IN USE retain a forecast snapshot

mutual action plan

Agreed customer and seller steps, owners, and timing.

IN USE validate the mutual action plan

recurring value

Value from repeating charges, with term and measurement rules specified.

IN USE define recurring value

08

Precision check

Contracting and Commit have explicit fictional requirements in this lesson. Other organizations may define their categories differently. Here the missing procurement start, confirmed signing window, and approval path require correction; they do not prove that the customer will never buy.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE EVIDENCE

"The customer attended the demonstration and expressed interest."

CHECK THE STAGE

"Procurement has not started, so Contracting does not meet our stated rule."

CHECK THE CATEGORY

"Commit requires a confirmed signing window and a documented approval path."

PRESERVE THE OPPORTUNITY

"Removing it from Commit does not mean marking it lost."

IDENTIFY THE UNSUPPORTED DATE

"The thirty-first of October is our estimate, not a confirmed signing date."

USE THE SUPPORTED STAGE

"Evaluation reflects the evidence currently available."

AVOID CONVERTING ENTHUSIASM

"A positive comment is not a purchase commitment."

CLARIFY THE AMOUNT

"Separate the twelve-month subscription from the one-time setup fee."

08

Our estimate

Attributes the date to the seller rather than the buyer.

Under our rule

Refers to this team's defined category requirements.

Currently available

Leaves room for later evidence without inventing it now.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID REVENUE CONFUSION

"A quote in the pipeline is not recognized revenue."

ASSIGN OWNERSHIP

"Mika owns the customer follow-up."

LABEL ESTIMATES HONESTLY

"Any retained internal target must remain clearly marked as unconfirmed."

USE EVIDENCE IN THE NEXT REVIEW

"Bring the customer's actual response, including any remaining unknowns."

NAME THE MISSING CUSTOMER ACTION

"We need to verify procurement steps, approvers, and timing."

SET THE DEADLINE

"Verify the buying steps by Monday at fourteen hundred Eastern."

KEEP HISTORY

"Record why the stage and forecast treatment changed."

CLOSE THE CORRECTION

"Update the stage, forecast category, amount basis, next step, owner, and evidence date."

08

Does not mean lost

Separates forecast confidence from the opportunity's continued existence.

Amount basis

States which charges and period a field includes.

Actual response

Keeps the follow-up tied to customer evidence rather than internal optimism.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which correction fits the stated policy?

- A** Mark Closed Won after a favorable demonstration.
- B** Delete the record as lost without customer evidence.
- C** Move to Evaluation and remove unsupported Commit treatment while keeping the opportunity active.
- D** Keep Contracting because the seller wants a strong month.

2. Which amount statement is accurate?

- A** All \$140,000 is already recognized revenue.
- B** A setup fee is recurring subscription value by definition.
- C** The quote has \$120,000 subscription plus \$20,000 setup; the recorded field must state its basis.
- D** The \$120,000 necessarily includes every first-year charge.

3. What should happen to an internal target date?

- A** Label it as an unconfirmed estimate and distinguish it from a customer commitment.
- B** Attribute it to the customer without asking.
- C** Treat it as proof procurement has started.
- D** Change the notes to claim a signed order.

4. Which next update is useful?

- A** A claim that every interested prospect closes immediately
- B** Customer-confirmed buying steps and remaining gaps, with the evidence date
- C** A larger probability chosen to satisfy the target
- D** The same unsupported date without new information

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The forecast date is the seller estimate, not a customer promise

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

mutual action plan / recurring value / close date / next-step owner / Recognized revenue / audit trail / forecast category / forecast snapshot / pipeline / stage exit criteria

08

- 01 **Jonas:** H27 is in Commit for the thirty-first of October, and the stage says Contracting. What customer evidence supports those entries?
- 02 **Mika:** The customer liked the demonstration, but I entered the ¹ _____ myself. Procurement has not started, and I do not have a confirmed signing window. I was using the month-end date as an internal target.
- 03 **Jonas:** Then we need to separate the customer response from our planning estimate. Which stage reflects what has actually happened?
- 04 **Mika:** Under our ² _____, Evaluation fits the evidence. Contracting requires procurement to have started, so the current stage is ahead of the customer process rather than a record of completed progress.
- 05 **Jonas:** Commit also has a specific definition. It needs a customer-confirmed signing window and a documented approval path, neither of which we have.
- 06 **Mika:** I will correct the ³ _____ and remove the unsupported Commit treatment. The opportunity can remain active while I establish those missing facts; correcting the forecast does not require calling the deal lost.
- 07 **Jonas:** Good. I want an accurate view of what could happen, not a confident number built from a favorable comment after a demonstration.
- 08 **Mika:** The ⁴ _____ should show the interest and the unresolved buying steps separately. A positive response is useful, but it is not an approved purchase, an executed order, or a completed procurement process.
- 09 **Jonas:** Check the amount as well. The quote has a twelve-month subscription of one hundred twenty thousand and a separate twenty-thousand setup charge.
- 10 **Mika:** I will clarify the ⁵ _____ and the one-time amount. If a field shows only the subscription, its definition should say so, rather than appear to include every first-year charge.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Jonas:** And neither the quoted subscription nor the combined amount should be described as revenue already earned from this opportunity.
- 12 **Mika:** Correct. ⁶ _____ is separate from a quote or forecast. I should also avoid calling the opportunity a booking or cash receipt before the relevant event and definition support that description.
- 13 **Jonas:** What will you ask the customer next? We need to know the steps and owners rather than request a signature date in isolation.
- 14 **Mika:** I will propose a ⁷ _____ after verifying the procurement process, approval path, and realistic timing. It should reflect their actual decisions and dependencies, not a seller schedule presented as already agreed.
- 15 **Jonas:** Please verify those buying steps by Monday at fourteen hundred Eastern and bring the response to the next review.
- 16 **Mika:** I am the ⁸ _____. I will record the response and any unresolved items. The commitment is to verify the process, not to guarantee a customer signature by that time.
- 17 **Jonas:** Keep the reason for the correction in the record. Otherwise the next reviewer may think the deal changed for a different reason.
- 18 **Mika:** I will preserve the ⁹ _____. The stage and category are changing because the previous entries lacked the required evidence, not because the customer has said it will never buy.
- 19 **Jonas:** At the next review, we can reassess confidence using the new information. Do not increase a probability merely to keep the total unchanged.
- 20 **Mika:** I will retain the ¹⁰ _____ with the amount basis, stage, next action, and evidence date. Any internal target will remain unconfirmed, not attributed to the customer.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. close date | 2. stage exit criteria | 3. forecast category | 4. pipeline | 5. recurring value | 6. Recognized revenue | 7. mutual action plan | 8. next-step owner | 9. audit trail | 10. forecast snapshot

Correct another unsupported forecast

F Say it

A seller enters 30 November as a close date after an encouraging demonstration. The buyer has not confirmed the date, and required approval steps are unknown. The team needs customer evidence before treating the deal as committed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unconfirmed / customer evidence / 30 November / demonstration

08

Manager: "The entered date is ¹ _____."

Seller: "The customer has attended a ² _____."

Manager: "The date's current status is ³ _____."

Seller: "Before commitment treatment, we need ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. 30 November | 2. demonstration | 3. unconfirmed | 4. customer evidence

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Discovery and Qualification

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What current workflow is described?

D. About 600 monthly purchase requests across four branches using spreadsheets and email

The brief specifies the volume, branch count, and existing tools without establishing product fit.

2. What is known about the problem?

D. Managers chase status, but waiting time and cost have not been measured.

Nina reports a practical problem, while its time and financial effects remain unmeasured.

3. What does the demonstration request establish?

D. Interest in seeing the product, not purchase approval

A request to see the product is evidence of interest, not the missing commercial approvals.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which demonstration objective fits the stated need?

B. Show request routing and status visibility in a relevant workflow.

Routing and status visibility connect directly to the reported workflow and status-chasing problem.

2. Which statement about budget is accurate?

D. The budget position has not yet been confirmed.

Missing budget information remains unknown rather than proving either available funding or its absence.

3. Which question clarifies the buying process?

C. Who evaluates the fit, controls funding, and authorizes the purchase?

The relevant roles and steps must be understood rather than inferred from a single interested contact.

4. Which benefit statement is supportable now?

B. We can examine whether status visibility addresses the problem; savings still need measurement.

The current facts support exploring fit, not a quantified or guaranteed improvement.

01 Conversation answers

Discovery and Qualification

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. demo objective.** Turn 2. The objective links the demonstration to the customer's workflow question rather than an unfocused tour of features.
- 2. current-state workflow.** Turn 4. The current-state workflow describes how requests move now, providing context for a relevant product demonstration.
- 3. pain point.** Turn 6. The pain point is status chasing; the location and measured size of the delay remain to be established.
- 4. baseline measure.** Turn 8. A baseline measure establishes current performance; request volume alone does not quantify waiting time or savings.
- 5. use case.** Turn 10. The use case is routing and status visibility in the approval workflow, not every capability the product offers.
- 6. buying process.** Turn 12. The buying process identifies evaluation and approval steps that Nina's demonstration request does not establish.
- 7. discovery gap.** Turn 14. A discovery gap is missing information, not proof that funding is either approved or unavailable.
- 8. compelling event.** Turn 16. A compelling event is a genuine customer timing driver, not a seller-created date inferred from interest.
- 9. solution fit.** Turn 18. Solution fit needs assessment against actual requirements; a successful demonstration alone does not establish it.
- 10. next step.** Turn 20. The next step is a focused agenda and follow-up, not an invented purchase approval or close date.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. email

Seller: "The existing coordination tool is email."

The brief identifies email as the current method across the three sites.

2. missed updates

Contact: "The reported problem is missed updates."

Missed updates are reported, but their frequency and impact have not been measured.

3. three

Seller: "The relevant number of sites is three."

Three sites define the stated operational footprint for this initial discussion.

4. unconfirmed

Contact: "The purchase date is unconfirmed."

A request to see the product does not establish a buying commitment or date.

02 Briefing and language checks

Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. How is the current 24-hour cycle divided?

A. 14 hours consolidation, 8 review, and 2 formatting

The three supplied work categories sum to twenty-four staff hours per monthly cycle.

2. What total follows from the proposed test assumption?

C. 16 hours, if consolidation falls to 6 and the other tasks stay unchanged

Six consolidation hours plus eight review and two formatting hours would total sixteen.

3. What has actually been demonstrated?

C. Consolidation with sample data, not verified customer results

The demonstration shows a capability on sample data, while customer fit and benefits remain unverified.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which value claim is accurate before the customer-data test?

C. The proposed change could free eight hours per cycle if the stated assumptions hold.

The conditional claim follows the supplied arithmetic while preserving the unverified customer result.

2. Why is the proposed total sixteen rather than six hours?

D. Review and formatting still require ten hours combined.

The six-hour consolidation assumption must be added to eight review hours and two formatting hours.

3. What should a relevant proof of value include?

B. Approved representative inputs, exceptions, measures, and agreed criteria

A meaningful test must reflect the relevant workflow and define what evidence would support the benefit.

4. Which distinction matters for the business case?

A. Freed staff capacity does not necessarily reduce cash spending.

Capacity can be useful without producing a cash reduction, so the benefit measure must be stated accurately.

02 Conversation answers

Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

1. value proposition. Turn 2. The value proposition should address the customer's reporting outcome, rather than merely list product capabilities.

2. baseline. Turn 4. The baseline is the current twenty-four-hour cycle, with the three work categories separately defined.

3. value hypothesis. Turn 6. The proposed six-hour consolidation result is a benefit hypothesis to test, not an achieved customer outcome.

4. workflow fit. Turn 8. Workflow fit depends on the real inputs and exceptions, which a smooth sample demonstration does not establish.

5. representative dataset. Turn 10. Representative data should reflect relevant branch formats and exceptions, rather than only easy records selected for a demonstration.

6. proof of value. Turn 12. Proof of value tests the proposed customer benefit against agreed measures and scope, rather than assuming demonstration success transfers automatically.

7. labor capacity. Turn 14. Labor capacity is staff time available for other work; no payroll or cash reduction is planned here.

8. assumption. Turn 16. The approximate one-third reduction depends on the unverified six-hour consolidation result and unchanged review and formatting work.

9. integration. Turn 18. Integration requirements are implementation dependencies that must be assessed before assuming the demonstrated capability works in the customer environment.

10. benefit owner. Turn 20. The benefit owner verifies and tracks the actual outcome, keeping responsibility separate from a seller's untested value claim.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. 18 hours

Seller: "The current total is 18 hours."

Ten combining hours plus six review and two formatting hours equals eighteen.

2. 4 hours

Buyer: "The proposed combining time is 4 hours."

Four hours is the test target, not a result already demonstrated.

3. 12 hours

Seller: "The conditional new total would be 12 hours."

Four combining hours plus six review and two formatting hours would total twelve.

4. 6 hours

Buyer: "The potential time released per cycle is 6 hours."

Eighteen minus twelve gives six hours of potential capacity, not an automatic cash saving.

03 Briefing and language checks

Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What is the headline annual price difference?

B. \$10,000

Forty-two thousand minus thirty-two thousand gives a ten-thousand-dollar difference between the quoted headline amounts.

2. What is unknown in the competitor offer?

B. The price of implementation support

The competitor excludes implementation support and supplies no price for that additional work.

3. Does Luis's quote provide round-the-clock support?

B. No; it specifies a weekday daytime window with holiday exclusions.

The stated weekday window and exclusions do not establish support at every hour or overnight.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which competitive statement is supported?

A. Their headline is \$10,000 lower, but equivalent-scope total cost is not yet established.

The stated prices establish a headline difference, while scope and unpriced implementation prevent a complete total-cost conclusion.

2. What does the four-support-hour term establish?

A. A stated initial-response commitment under the specified service calendar

The term concerns initial response within covered support time, not universal elapsed-time resolution.

3. How should Luis respond to overnight needs?

A. Acknowledge that the quoted window does not cover them and check appropriate options.

The honest response identifies the current coverage gap and seeks a verified option instead of misrepresenting the quote.

4. What would improve the comparison?

A. A priced equivalent implementation scope and clarified service calendars

Comparable scope and clear calendars resolve material differences that headline prices alone cannot address.

03 Conversation answers

Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

1. headline price. Turn 2. The headline price is genuinely ten thousand lower; acknowledging it does not settle the equivalent-scope total-cost comparison.

2. unpriced item. Turn 4. Implementation support has no supplied competitor price, leaving the equivalent-scope cost comparison incomplete.

3. initial response. Turn 6. Initial response is the specified first support engagement, not a guaranteed completed fix within the same period.

4. support window. Turn 8. The quoted support window is weekdays, 09:00-17:00 Eastern, excluding listed holidays; it is not continuous coverage.

5. Elapsed time. Turn 10. Elapsed time runs continuously, unlike hours counted only within a specified support calendar.

6. selection criterion. Turn 12. The selection criterion should reflect the buyer's actual overnight need rather than favor a faster daytime metric alone.

7. like-for-like comparison. Turn 14. A like-for-like comparison uses equivalent scope and verified terms, without inventing claims about the competing supplier's quality.

8. severity levels. Turn 16. Severity levels may affect support commitments; the classifications need checking rather than assuming equal treatment across suppliers.

9. cost normalization. Turn 18. Cost normalization puts offers on a consistent scope and time basis, including relevant one-time and recurring charges.

10. commercial clarification. Turn 20. Commercial clarification resolves a specific missing term or price before the buyer relies on a completed comparison.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. \$6,000

Buyer: "The headline annual difference is \$6,000."

Twenty-eight thousand minus twenty-two thousand gives a six-thousand-dollar headline difference.

2. onboarding service

Seller: "Offer B has an unpriced onboarding service."

Onboarding is excluded from B and has no supplied additional price.

3. initial response

Buyer: "The support promise concerns initial response."

Both quoted terms describe the first response, not a guaranteed completed fix.

4. not yet established

Seller: "Equivalent-scope total cost is not yet established."

The missing onboarding price prevents a complete comparison of equivalent packages.

04 Briefing and language checks

Pricing, Discounting, and Approval

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What is the base for the requested 15% reduction?

C. The \$80,000 subscription fee only

The buyer requests a subscription reduction while leaving the separate setup fee unchanged.

2. What would the requested pre-tax first-year total be?

C. \$72,000

The reduced subscription would be sixty-eight thousand plus the unchanged four-thousand setup fee.

3. Can Alina approve the 15% request?

C. No; it requires the commercial director.

Alina's authority is at most five percent under the stated terms, so the larger reduction requires escalation.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which calculation matches the request?

B. \$80,000 minus \$12,000, plus \$4,000 setup, equals \$72,000 before tax.

The correct calculation applies the reduction only to subscription and retains the separate setup charge.

2. Which status statement avoids a premature commitment?

C. The requested total would be \$72,000 before tax, subject to the required approval.

Conditional wording distinguishes the requested calculation from the actual authority to issue a revised offer.

3. What is promised for Thursday at 16:00?

B. A status update

Alina commits to communication at that time, not to an outcome outside her authority.

4. Which deadline should be communicated?

A. The existing 31 October quote-validity date

The supplied quote remains valid through the stated date; no earlier limit has been established.

04 Conversation answers

Pricing, Discounting, and Approval

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. discount base.** Turn 2. The reduction applies to the eighty-thousand subscription, not the separate setup charge or the entire quote.
- 2. discount amount.** Turn 4. Fifteen percent of eighty thousand is twelve thousand, leaving sixty-eight thousand for the subscription.
- 3. pre-tax total.** Turn 6. The seventy-two-thousand total combines the requested subscription and unchanged setup fee before applicable taxes.
- 4. delegated authority.** Turn 8. Alina can approve at most five percent under the stated standard terms, not the requested fifteen percent.
- 5. pricing exception.** Turn 10. The fifteen-percent request is an unapproved departure requiring the commercial director's decision.
- 6. payment terms.** Turn 12. Different payment timing changes the commercial package and needs assessment; it does not automatically approve the requested discount.
- 7. give-get.** Turn 14. A give-get links a specified concession to a reciprocal commitment, rather than silently combining discounts and changed terms.
- 8. quote validity.** Turn 16. The existing quote remains valid until 31 October; no earlier deadline is supported by the supplied terms.
- 9. approval workflow.** Turn 18. The workflow routes the request to the authorized decision-maker; the promised update does not guarantee approval by that time.
- 10. approved quote.** Turn 20. An approved quote records the actual authorized terms, unlike an illustrative calculation or a request still under review.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. \$50,000

Seller: "The discount base is \$50,000."

The reduction applies only to the subscription, not the separate setup fee.

2. \$5,000

Buyer: "The requested discount amount is \$5,000."

Ten percent of fifty thousand equals five thousand dollars.

3. \$48,000

Seller: "The requested total before tax would be \$48,000."

Forty-five thousand in reduced subscription plus three thousand setup gives forty-eight thousand.

4. pending

Buyer: "The approval status is pending."

The seller lacks authority to approve the exception, and no required decision has been supplied.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Enterprise Buying Committees

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What can Devon contribute?

A. The workflow need and operational evaluation context

Devon understands the operational need but explicitly lacks budget control and signing authority.

2. Who owns vendor onboarding?

B. Procurement

The brief assigns the vendor-onboarding process to procurement.

3. Which authority is still unidentified?

B. The authorized contract signer

The finance and procurement roles are identified, but contract-signing authority remains unknown.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which internal account note is accurate?

A. Devon supports the need; budget, procurement, security, and signer steps remain unresolved.

The note distinguishes support from the separate uncompleted reviews and unknown signing authority.

2. Which question broadens access respectfully?

A. How can we involve the relevant reviewers while keeping you included?

An agreed introduction supports transparent evaluation while preserving the main contact's involvement.

3. What does a technical win establish in this context?

A. A favorable technical assessment, not necessarily budget or contract approval

Technical preference concerns suitability and does not substitute for separate commercial and contractual decisions.

4. What should the role map distinguish?

C. Owners, evaluation criteria, sequence, current status, and unknown authority

A usable map explains responsibilities and remaining steps rather than relying on titles or favorable opinions.

05 Conversation answers

Enterprise Buying Committees

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. buying committee. Turn 2. The buying committee includes the roles needed to evaluate and authorize the purchase, beyond one supportive contact.

2. budget approval. Turn 4. Budget approval belongs to the finance director in this scenario, not to Devon because he likes the proposal.

3. vendor onboarding. Turn 6. Vendor onboarding is a separate procurement process that has not begun; interest in the proposal does not complete it.

4. security review. Turn 8. Security review is required separately; the demonstration does not establish that the buyer's information-security conditions are satisfied.

5. authorized signer. Turn 10. Signing authority is still unidentified and must not be inferred from budget responsibility or a senior job title.

6. decision process. Turn 12. The decision process maps evaluation roles and sequence, including steps that can run together and those with dependencies.

7. paper process. Turn 14. The paper process covers administrative and contractual steps toward signature, distinct from merely choosing a preferred solution.

8. access path. Turn 16. An agreed access path involves the necessary reviewers transparently while keeping the main contact appropriately included.

9. decision criteria. Turn 18. Different reviewers may assess different requirements, so the criteria need explicit confirmation rather than a single assumed preference.

10. stakeholder map. Turn 20. The map records known roles, unconfirmed authority, review status, and next actions without inventing purchase approval.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. finance

Seller: "The funding role belongs to finance."

Finance holds the stated funding-approval responsibility, not the supportive department lead.

2. procurement

Lead: "Supplier registration belongs to procurement."

Procurement owns the separate supplier-registration process in this scenario.

3. technical team

Seller: "Compatibility is evaluated by the technical team."

The technical team's role concerns compatibility, not automatic funding or contract approval.

4. unknown

Lead: "The contract signer remains unknown."

No signing authority has been identified, so it must not be inferred from another role.

06 Briefing and language checks

Negotiation and Contract Redlines

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What change has the buyer proposed?

A. Removing the stated liability cap in clause 10.2 of version 4

The brief identifies the version, clause, and proposed removal of the cap without treating it as agreed.

2. Can Marcus accept the wording?

B. No; he lacks the required legal and commercial approval authority.

The stated company process requires reviews and approvals Marcus does not hold.

3. What is promised at 16:00 Eastern?

D. A review-status update

Marcus commits to a status communication, not an outcome reserved for the required reviewers and approvers.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which acknowledgment preserves the actual status?

A. I received version 4; clause 10.2 remains under the required review and is not accepted.

The acknowledgment confirms receipt and preserves the unresolved review without implying legal or commercial assent.

2. What should Marcus send for review?

A. The full marked agreement with the exact version and business concern

Exact wording and context let the qualified reviewers assess the actual proposal rather than a distorted summary.

3. What can Marcus responsibly promise today?

B. A status update at 16:00 Eastern

The only supported commitment is communication at the stated time, not an unapproved review result.

4. Which check belongs before signature?

A. Reconcile the clean text with the authorized negotiated version.

The final text must match the authorized position rather than merely look finished.

06 Conversation answers

Negotiation and Contract Redlines

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. redline.** Turn 2. The redline contains proposed changes; receiving it does not mean the seller has accepted the wording.
- 2. liability cap.** Turn 4. The liability cap's effect depends on the full wording and legal context, which Marcus is not authorized to determine.
- 3. uncapped liability.** Turn 6. The request removes the specified cap, but its consequences require review of the full agreement and applicable law.
- 4. markup.** Turn 8. The markup preserves the actual additions and deletions so reviewers assess the customer's exact proposal.
- 5. approved fallback.** Turn 10. No alternative wording is authorized for this request, so Marcus must not improvise a supposedly approved substitute.
- 6. escalation.** Turn 12. Escalation routes the urgent request to the proper reviewers without transferring their authority to the salesperson.
- 7. negotiating position.** Turn 14. The negotiating position remains subject to authorized review; the update may report pending status rather than an accepted term.
- 8. version control.** Turn 16. Version control distinguishes the exchanged proposals and authorized text, reducing the risk of reviewing or signing the wrong revision.
- 9. clean version.** Turn 18. A clean version removes visible change marks but does not itself prove that its wording was reviewed or approved.
- 10. authorized signatory.** Turn 20. The signatory must hold the relevant execution authority; the account executive's acknowledgment does not establish it.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. version 7

Seller: "The received document is version 7."

The supplied version identifier distinguishes this proposal from other exchanged documents.

2. clause 8.3

Buyer: "The changed provision is clause 8.3."

Clause 8.3 is the specific provision identified for review.

3. acceptance

Seller: "Receipt does not mean acceptance."

Acknowledging the proposal does not authorize or agree to the changed wording.

4. 11:00 Central

Buyer: "The promised status update is at 11:00 Central."

This is the stated communication deadline, not a guarantee of approval or signature.

06

07 Briefing and language checks

Partnerships and Channel Development

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What is missing from the initial exclusivity request?

C. Defined territory, products, duration, and contribution

The initial request leaves the scope and contribution undefined, so it is not a complete proposed arrangement.

2. What pilot is being considered?

B. A six-month nonexclusive scheduling-product pilot in Region North

The brief specifies a bounded nonexclusive pilot for assessment, while all terms remain unapproved.

3. What does four qualified opportunities per quarter mean here?

D. Four opportunities meeting the stated need, contact, and next-step criteria

The supplied qualification definition concerns opportunity evidence, not completed purchases or revenue.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which response handles exclusivity appropriately?

A. Define the scope and contribution, then route the proposal for the required review without promising the right.

Undefined rights need concrete terms and authorized review; enthusiasm alone does not grant exclusivity.

2. Which item meets the supplied qualification definition?

B. A prospect with a stated need, relevant contact, and agreed next step

The first item contains all three stated qualification elements while remaining an opportunity rather than a sale.

3. How should the \$5,000 be described?

A. An unapproved marketing-support request

The brief supplies a request only, without authority to spend, reimburse, or pay it.

4. What should a pilot agreement clarify beyond lead targets?

B. Rights, product scope, territory, support roles, attribution, funding, and review

A workable proposal needs the complete relationship boundaries and responsibilities, not a target alone.

07 Conversation answers

Partnerships and Channel Development

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

- 1. exclusivity.** Turn 2. Exclusivity needs specified boundaries and authorized review; interest in partnering does not create a sole right.
- 2. channel partner.** Turn 4. The channel role may involve introductions, resale, or delivery; those activities carry different responsibilities that need agreement.
- 3. nonexclusive.** Turn 6. Nonexclusive describes the proposed pilot rights; it does not mean the pilot or its other terms are already approved.
- 4. product scope.** Turn 8. The proposed product scope is scheduling only, paired with Region North and the six-month term.
- 5. performance target.** Turn 10. The proposed target is four qualified opportunities per quarter, not a guaranteed number of purchases.
- 6. qualified opportunity.** Turn 12. Qualification here requires need, contact, and an agreed next step; it does not establish an order or revenue.
- 7. deal registration.** Turn 14. Deal registration records partner opportunities under agreed rules so overlapping work and account claims can be handled consistently.
- 8. attribution rules.** Turn 16. Attribution rules establish credit for the actual contributions, rather than allowing competing assumptions about ownership or compensation.
- 9. MDF.** Turn 18. Market development funds are only requested here; the five-thousand amount has not been approved for spending or reimbursement.
- 10. support handoff.** Turn 20. The support handoff defines who assists customers and when responsibility changes, alongside the pilot's review arrangements.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. nonexclusive

Manager: "The proposed rights are nonexclusive."

The proposal does not grant a sole selling right in the stated pilot arrangement.

2. four months

Partner: "The proposed term is four months."

Four months defines the proposed pilot duration, not a permanent appointment.

3. inventory product

Manager: "The product scope is the inventory product."

The proposal names one offering rather than the entire catalog.

4. three

Partner: "The quarterly opportunity target is three."

Three qualified opportunities is the proposed contribution target, not a guarantee of signed orders.

08 Briefing and language checks

CRM Hygiene and Pipeline Reviews

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. Who supplied the 31 October close date?

C. Mika entered it as a seller estimate.

The date is seller-entered and has no customer-confirmed signing basis.

2. Why is Contracting unsupported under the stated policy?

C. Procurement has not started.

This team's Contracting condition requires procurement to have begun, which the supplied facts say has not happened.

3. What is Mika required to do by Monday at 14:00 Eastern?

B. Verify the buying steps with the customer

The follow-up is to establish the customer process, not to promise an unsupported commercial or accounting outcome.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which correction fits the stated policy?

C. Move to Evaluation and remove unsupported Commit treatment while keeping the opportunity active.

Evaluation matches the known progress, while the missing approval and timing evidence fails the defined Commit conditions.

2. Which amount statement is accurate?

C. The quote has \$120,000 subscription plus \$20,000 setup; the recorded field must state its basis.

Charge types and field definitions must remain clear, and a quote does not establish completed sales or accounting revenue.

3. What should happen to an internal target date?

A. Label it as an unconfirmed estimate and distinguish it from a customer commitment.

An internal planning estimate may be recorded as such, but its source and uncertainty must not be disguised.

4. Which next update is useful?

B. Customer-confirmed buying steps and remaining gaps, with the evidence date

The next review needs actual process evidence rather than a revised number unsupported by customer progress.

08 Conversation answers

CRM Hygiene and Pipeline Reviews

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. close date.** Turn 2. The close date is Mika's estimate, not a signing date confirmed by the customer.
- 2. stage exit criteria.** Turn 4. The team requires procurement to have started before Contracting; the known demonstration status fits Evaluation instead.
- 3. forecast category.** Turn 6. The forecast category must reflect the stated evidence requirements; positive feedback does not support Commit here.
- 4. pipeline.** Turn 8. The pipeline can retain a live opportunity without treating it as committed or completed revenue.
- 5. recurring value.** Turn 10. Recurring subscription value is distinct from the one-time setup charge; the forecast field needs a clear inclusion basis.
- 6. Recognized revenue.** Turn 12. Recognized revenue follows applicable accounting rules and is not established by a quote, forecast category, or positive customer comment.
- 7. mutual action plan.** Turn 14. A mutual action plan requires agreement on actual customer and seller steps, not a timetable imposed by the seller.
- 8. next-step owner.** Turn 16. Mika owns the customer follow-up by the stated deadline; that action does not guarantee a signed purchase.
- 9. audit trail.** Turn 18. The audit trail records the evidence-based correction and its reason, rather than rewriting history to imply earlier customer confirmation.
- 10. forecast snapshot.** Turn 20. A forecast snapshot preserves what was estimated at a particular time, including corrections and uncertainty rather than invented certainty.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. 30 November

Manager: "The entered date is 30 November."

This is the seller-entered date in the record, not an independently confirmed customer commitment.

2. demonstration

Seller: "The customer has attended a demonstration."

The demonstration is the stated progress evidence, not a signed or approved purchase.

3. unconfirmed

Manager: "The date's current status is unconfirmed."

The buyer has not confirmed the date, so it must remain an estimate.

4. customer evidence

Seller: "Before commitment treatment, we need customer evidence."

The team's requirement is evidence of the buying process and timing, not enthusiasm alone.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Discovery and Qualification

Respect the request: We can show the product; first, may I clarify what would make the demonstration useful?

Clarify the problem: Where do managers lose visibility or need to chase an update?

Define the demonstration: Let us focus on routing requests and seeing their current status.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit

Start with the workflow: Which part of preparing the report consumes the most time?

Keep other work visible: Review and formatting do not disappear in this proposal.

Avoid a guaranteed claim: The customer-data test has not yet established that saving.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure

Acknowledge the price difference: Their headline quote is ten thousand dollars lower.

Keep the gap explicit: We do not yet have a price for their implementation support.

Distinguish clock time: Support hours are not the same as continuous elapsed hours.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Pricing, Discounting, and Approval

Confirm the request: You are asking for fifteen percent off the subscription only.

State the conditional price: The requested subscription would be sixty-eight thousand dollars.

Name the approver: The fifteen-percent exception requires the commercial director.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Enterprise Buying Committees

Recognize the support: Your understanding of the workflow will help us make the evaluation relevant.

Ask about procurement: What vendor-onboarding steps need to happen?

Ask about criteria: What does each group need to establish before it can support the purchase?

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Negotiation and Contract Redlines

Acknowledge receipt: I have received your marked version four.

Preserve the status: I am acknowledging the proposal, not accepting the wording.

Keep the text intact: I will send the full marked agreement, not a paraphrase of the clause alone.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Partnerships and Channel Development

Clarify the activity: Are you proposing referrals, resale, implementation, or a combination?

Offer a bounded assessment: We can assess a six-month nonexclusive pilot.

Define qualification: Each opportunity needs an identified need, relevant contact, and agreed next step.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 CRM Hygiene and Pipeline Reviews

State the evidence: The customer attended the demonstration and expressed interest.

Use the supported stage: Evaluation reflects the evidence currently available.

Clarify the amount: Separate the twelve-month subscription from the one-time setup fee.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acceptance	avoid unintended acceptance	51
acceptance criterion	set acceptance criteria	15
access path	agree an access path	42
ACV	define ACV consistently	33
approval threshold	check the approval threshold	32
approval workflow	follow the approval workflow	33
approved fallback	check the approved fallback	51
approved quote	issue an approved quote	33
assumption	disclose the assumptions	15
attribution rule	agree attribution rules	60
audit trail	preserve the audit trail	69
authorized signatory	verify the authorized signatory	51
authorized signer	identify the authorized signer	42
BANT	use BANT questions	5
baseline	confirm the baseline	15
baseline measure	establish a baseline measure	6
benefit owner	identify the benefit owner	15
best case	qualify the best-case estimate	68
bookings	distinguish bookings	69
budget approval	obtain budget approval	41
budget holder	identify the budget holder	5
business case	build the business case	14
business hour	define business hours	24
business impact	quantify business impact	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

business outcome	define the business outcome	14
buyer-confirmed date	record a buyer-confirmed date	68
buying committee	map the buying committee	41
buying process	clarify the buying process	6
carve-out	identify a carve-out	51
cash saving	distinguish cash savings	15
champion	verify the champion's role	41
channel conflict	manage channel conflict	60
channel partner	develop a channel partner	59
clean version	reconcile the clean version	50
close date	verify the close date	68
Closed Won	verify Closed Won criteria	69
co-selling	agree co-selling roles	59
coach	learn from a coach	41
commercial approval	confirm commercial approval	42
commercial clarification	request commercial clarification	24
Commit	substantiate Commit status	68
compatibility	verify compatibility	15
compelling event	verify the compelling event	6
competitive quote	review the competitive quote	23
concession	evaluate a concession	33
configuration	confirm the configuration	15
consequential loss	refer consequential-loss wording	51
contract clause	identify the contract clause	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

contract term clarify the contract term	33
cost normalization perform cost normalization	24
CPQ update the CPQ record	33
CRM update the CRM	68
current-state workflow map the current-state workflow	5
data readiness assess data readiness	15
deal desk consult the deal desk	32
deal registration confirm deal registration	60
decision criteria confirm decision criteria	41
decision process map the decision process	41
decision-maker identify the decision-maker	6
delegated authority stay within delegated authority	32
demo objective agree the demo objective	6
demonstration tailor the demonstration	6
discount amount calculate the discount amount	32
discount base identify the discount base	32
discovery agenda agree a discovery agenda	6
discovery call conduct a discovery call	5
discovery gap identify a discovery gap	5
distributor work with a distributor	59
DPA route the DPA for review	51
economic buyer identify the economic buyer	41
elapsed time distinguish elapsed time	24
end user involve end users	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

end user involve end users	41
escalation escalate the redline	51
exception handling assess exception handling	15
exclusivity assess exclusivity terms	59
executive sponsor confirm the executive sponsor	42
feature demonstrate a feature	14
feature-to-value link explain the feature-to-value link	14
forecast category review the forecast category	68
forecast snapshot retain a forecast snapshot	69
gatekeeper understand the gatekeeper's requirements	41
give-get document the give-get	33
governing law confirm governing law	50
headline price compare headline prices	23
holiday exclusion check holiday exclusions	24
ICP define the ICP	5
implementation support specify implementation support	23
indemnity review the indemnity	50
influencer understand the influencer	41
initial response confirm initial-response terms	23
integration scope the integration	15
ISV coordinate an ISV partnership	59
jurisdiction review jurisdiction terms	50
labor capacity release labor capacity	15
lead follow up a lead	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

liability cap	review the liability cap	50
like-for-like comparison	make a like-for-like comparison	23
list price	confirm the list price	32
loss reason	record the loss reason	69
manual consolidation	reduce manual consolidation	14
margin	assess margin impact	33
markup	preserve the markup	50
MDF	request MDF	60
MSA	review the MSA	51
MSP	engage an MSP	59
multi-threaded	develop a multi-threaded engagement	42
mutual action plan	develop a mutual action plan	6
mutual action plan	validate the mutual action plan	69
negotiating position	clarify the negotiating position	51
net price	state the net price	32
next step	agree the next step	6
next-step owner	identify the next-step owner	69
nonexclusive	propose a nonexclusive pilot	59
objection	clarify the objection	23
one-time fee	identify one-time fees	24
opportunity	maintain the opportunity record	68
order form	reconcile the order form	51
pain point	clarify the pain point	5
paper process	clarify the paper process	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

partner enablement	deliver partner enablement	59
payment terms	confirm payment terms	33
performance target	define performance targets	60
pipeline	review the pipeline	68
pipeline coverage	define pipeline coverage	68
pre-tax total	calculate the pre-tax total	32
prepayment	assess a prepayment option	33
price book	use the approved price book	32
pricing exception	request a pricing exception	32
procurement	engage procurement	41
product scope	specify the product scope	60
proof of value	agree a proof of value	14
prospect	understand the prospect	5
qualification	complete opportunity qualification	5
qualified opportunity	document qualified opportunities	60
quantified benefit	substantiate a quantified benefit	14
quote validity	confirm quote validity	24
quote validity	preserve quote validity	33
recognized revenue	separate recognized revenue	69
recurring charge	separate recurring charges	24
recurring value	define recurring value	69
redline	review the redline	50
referral partner	define a referral partnership	59
renewal review	schedule a renewal review	60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

representation	review the representation	50
representative dataset	use a representative dataset	15
reseller	appoint a reseller	59
resolution time	distinguish resolution time	23
sales velocity	define sales velocity	69
scope alignment	establish scope alignment	23
security review	coordinate the security review	42
selection criterion	clarify selection criteria	24
sell-in	measure sell-in	60
sell-through	track sell-through	60
setup fee	separate the setup fee	32
severity level	confirm severity levels	24
signature workflow	confirm the signature workflow	51
single-threaded	identify a single-threaded opportunity	42
SLA	review the SLA	23
slippage	explain forecast slippage	69
solution fit	validate solution fit	6
stage age	monitor stage age	68
stage exit criterion	verify stage exit criteria	68
stakeholder alignment	build stakeholder alignment	42
stakeholder concern	address stakeholder concerns	42
stakeholder map	maintain the stakeholder map	42
stale opportunity	review stale opportunities	69
subscription fee	compare subscription fees	24

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

subscription term	confirm the subscription term	32
support handoff	define the support handoff	60
support tier	compare support tiers	23
support window	check the support window	23
TCO	assess TCO	23
TCV	calculate TCV	33
technical evaluator	engage the technical evaluator	6
technical win	distinguish a technical win	42
term	agree the pilot term	60
territory	define the territory	59
third-party claim	assess third-party claims	51
time-to-value	estimate time-to-value	14
uncapped liability	assess proposed uncapped liability	50
unpriced item	flag unpriced items	24
use case	define the use case	5
value hypothesis	validate the value hypothesis	14
value proposition	tailor the value proposition	14
value realization	track value realization	14
VAR	assess a VAR model	59
vendor onboarding	complete vendor onboarding	42
version control	maintain version control	50
warranty	clarify the warranty	50
weighted pipeline	interpret weighted pipeline	68
workflow fit	test workflow fit	14

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] Salesforce. What is a Sales Pipeline? And How Do You Build One? (2025).

[Open the original source](#)

Background terminology for qualification, customer progress, and pipeline records. Stage names and approval rules in the exercises are fictional. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] MEDDIC. MEDDIC / MEDDPICC sales methodology and process.

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Background for commonly heard buying-role and decision-process terms. The book is not framework certification or a reproduction of proprietary training. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] Federal Trade Commission. Advertising FAQs: A Guide for Small Business.

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[4] Cornell Legal Information Institute. Wex: Contract.

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Background on agreements and differing legal contexts. Contract dialogue practices routing and authority, not enforceability analysis or advice on accepting clauses. Checked 1 October 2026.

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